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BANDWIDTH PART FOR SENSING FUNCTIONS OF A CELLULAR WIRELESS DEVICE

Abstract

A method performed by a user equipment (UE) can include transmitting, to a configuring node, capability information that includes a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the UE for sensing functions, and receiving from the configuring node, configuration information in the form of a message indicating allocation of a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) to the UE by the configuring node. The UE may utilize the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions. Another method performed by a configuring node can include receiving, from a UE, capability information that includes an RF bandwidth supported by the UE for sensing functions. The configuring node may allocate to the UE, a first RF BWP that can be based on the RF bandwidth supported by the UE for sensing functions, and may transmit to the user equipment, information about the first RF BWP.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

1. Field of Disclosure

[0001] The present disclosure relates generally to the field of radio frequency (RF) sensing, and more specifically to RF sensing in a wireless network.

2. Description of Related Art

[0002] The performance of RF sensing by wireless devices can have a wide range of consumer, industrial, commercial, and other applications. RF sensing can be used to determine the presence of a target object, determine the location of the target object, and/or track the movement of the target object over time. Cellular networks (e.g., fifth-generation (5G) new radio (NR) networks) and other types of wireless networks may be capable of performing RF sensing using base stations, user equipment (UEs), and/or other wireless devices communicatively coupled with the cellular network as “sensing nodes.” Configuring a wireless device to perform RF sensing operations can involve ensuring inter-operability of the wireless devices with one or more other devices that can be a part of the cellular network.

BRIEF SUMMARY

[0003] Particular aspects of the subject matter described in this disclosure can be implemented to realize one or more of the following potential advantages. One potential advantage pertains to enabling a user device to perform high-resolution sensing operations based on an RF BWP that is larger than a BWP used by the user device for communications. More particularly, in an example implementation, a user device can use a low-speed analog-to-digital converter (ADC) for analog-to-digital conversion of a narrowband demodulated signal that is derived from a reflected wideband RF signal during a high-resolution sensing operation using an RF BWP. The use of a low-speed ADC having a low sampling rate provides various advantages in accordance with the disclosure, such as, for example, advantages associated with costs, complexity, and power consumption. Thus, allocation of an RF BWP based on a user device's capability to perform high resolution sensing allows optimizing of the user device's sensing capabilities without sacrificing other capabilities.

[0004] Particular aspects of the subject matter described in this disclosure include an example method performed by a user equipment to configure the user equipment for sensing functions, can include transmitting, to a configuring node, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; receiving, from the configuring node, configuration information comprising a message indicating allocation of a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) to the user equipment by the configuring node; and utilizing the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions.

[0005] An additional aspect of the subject matter described in this disclosure includes an example method performed by a configuring node to support a user equipment for performing sensing functions, can include receiving, from the user equipment, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; allocating, to the user equipment, a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) that is based, at least in part, on the RF bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; and transmitting, to the user equipment, information about the first RF BWP allocated to the user equipment.

[0006] An additional aspect of the subject matter described in this disclosure includes an example user equipment that performs sensing functions can include at least one memory and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the memory/memories. The one or more processors are configured to transmit, to a configuring node, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; receive, from the configuring node, configuration information comprising a message indicating allocation of a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) to the user equipment by the configuring node; and utilize the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions.

[0007] An additional aspect of the subject matter described in this disclosure includes an example

configuring node that supports a user equipment for performing sensing functions can include at least one memory and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the memory/memories. The one or more processors are configured to receive, from the user equipment, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; allocate, to the user equipment, a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) that is based, at least in part, on the RF bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; and transmit, to the user equipment, information about the first RF BWP allocated to the user equipment.

[0008] This summary is neither intended to identify key or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used in isolation to determine the scope of the claimed subject matter. The subject matter should be understood by reference to appropriate portions of the entire specification of this disclosure, any or all drawings, and each claim. The foregoing, together with other features and examples, will be described in more detail below in the following specification, claims, and accompanying drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0009] FIG. 1 is a simplified illustration of a positioning/sensing system, according to an embodiment.

[0010] FIG. 2 is a diagram of a fifth-generation (5G) new radio (NR) positioning/sensing system, according to an embodiment.

[0011] FIG. 3 is a diagram showing an example of a radio frequency (RF) sensing system.

[0012] FIG. 4 is a diagram showing some example functional elements of a UE, according to an embodiment.

[0013] FIG. 5 is a flow diagram showing information exchange between a UE and a configuring node to enable the UE to utilize an RF BWP in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0014] FIG. 6 is a flow diagram showing information exchange between a UE and a configuring node to enable the UE to utilize an RF BWP in accordance with another embodiment of the disclosure.

[0015] FIG. 7 shows a table that includes some types of switching delays associated with some example operations performed in accordance with the disclosure.

[0016] FIG. 8 shows a table that includes some example parameters that can be associated with frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations in accordance with the disclosure.

[0017] FIG. 9 shows a flowchart of a method performed by a user equipment for executing sensing functions in accordance with the disclosure.

[0018] FIG. 10 shows a flowchart of a method performed by a configuring node to support a user equipment for performing sensing functions in accordance with the disclosure.

[0019] FIG. 11 shows a block diagram of a user equipment in accordance an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0020] FIG. 12 is a block diagram of a network node in accordance an embodiment of the disclosure.

[0021] FIG. 13 is a block diagram of an embodiment of a computer system, which may be used, in whole or in part, to provide the functions of one or more components and/or devices as described in the embodiments herein.

[0022] Like reference symbols in the various drawings indicate like elements, in accordance with certain example implementations. In addition, multiple instances of an element may be indicated by following a first number for the element with a letter or a hyphen and a second number. For example, multiple instances of an element **110** may be indicated as **110-1**, **110-2**, **110-3**, etc. or as

110a, 110b, 110c, etc. When referring to such an element using only the first number, any instance of the element is to be understood (e.g., element **110** in the previous example would refer to elements **110-1, 110-2, and 110-3** or to elements **110a, 110b, and 110c**).

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0023] The following description is directed to certain implementations for the purposes of describing innovative aspects of various embodiments. However, a person having ordinary skill in the art will readily recognize that the teachings herein can be applied in a multitude of different ways. The described implementations may be implemented in any device, system, or network that is capable of transmitting and receiving radio frequency (RF) signals according to any communication standard, such as any of the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 802.15.4 standards for ultra-wideband (UWB), IEEE 802.11 standards (including those identified as Wi-Fi® technologies), the Bluetooth® standard, code division multiple access (CDMA), frequency division multiple access (FDMA), time division multiple access (TDMA), Global System for Mobile communications (GSM), GSM/General Packet Radio Service (GPRS), Enhanced Data GSM Environment (EDGE), Terrestrial Trunked Radio (TETRA), Wideband-CDMA (W-CDMA), Evolution Data Optimized (EV-DO), 1×EV-DO, EV-DO Rev A, EV-DO Rev B, High Rate Packet Data (HRPD), High Speed Packet Access (HSPA), High Speed Downlink Packet Access (HSDPA), High Speed Uplink Packet Access (HSUPA), Evolved High Speed Packet Access (HSPA+), Long Term Evolution (LTE), Advanced Mobile Phone System (AMPS), or other known signals that are used to communicate within a wireless, cellular or internet of things (IoT) network, such as a system utilizing 3G, 4G, 5G, 6G, or further implementations thereof, technology.

[0024] As used herein, an “RF signal” comprises an electromagnetic wave that transports information through the space between a transmitter (or transmitting device) and a receiver (or receiving device). As used herein, a transmitter may transmit a single “RF signal” or multiple “RF signals” to a receiver. However, the receiver may receive multiple “RF signals” corresponding to each transmitted RF signal due to the propagation characteristics of RF signals through multiple channels or paths.

[0025] As used herein, the terms “RF sensing,” “passive RF sensing,” and variants refer to a process by which one or more objects are detected using RF signals transmitted by a transmitting device and, after reflecting from the one or more objects, received by a receiving device. In a monostatic configuration, the transmitting and receiving devices are the same device. In a bistatic configuration, one device transmits RF signals, and another device receives reflections of the RF signals from one or more objects. In multi-static configuration, one or more receiving devices are separate from one or more transmitting devices. As used herein, the term “static” in the terms “monostatic,” “bistatic,” and “multistatic” (or “multi-static”) are meant to conform with historical literature on RF sensing but are not limited to “static” or stationary sensing nodes. As described herein, in some embodiments, sensing nodes may be mobile. As described herein, devices performing RF sensing may be referred to as “RF sensing nodes” or simply “sensing nodes.” In a bistatic or multi-static configuration, transmitting devices may be referred to as “transmitting nodes,” “Tx sensing nodes,” or “Tx nodes,” and receiving devices may be referred to as “receiving nodes,” “Rx sensing nodes,” or “Rx nodes.” As described hereafter in more detail, a receiving device can make measurements of these reflected RF signals to determine one or more characteristics of the one or more objects, such as location, range, angle, direction, orientation, Doppler, velocity, etc. According to some embodiments, RF sensing may be “passive” in that no RF signals need to be transmitted by the receiving device or one or more objects for the one or more objects to be detected.

[0026] Additionally, unless otherwise specified, references to “reference signals” and the like may be used to refer to signals used for positioning of a user equipment (UE), sensing of active and/or passive objects by one or more sensing nodes, or a combination thereof. As described in more

detail herein, such signals may comprise any of a variety of signal types. This may include but is not limited to, a positioning reference signal (PRS), sounding reference signal (SRS), synchronization signal block (SSB), channel start information reference signal (CSI-RS), or any combination thereof.

[0027] Techniques provided herein may apply to “mmWave” technologies, which typically operate at 57-71 GHz, but may include frequencies ranging from 30-300 GHz. This includes, for example, frequencies utilized by the 802.11ad Wi-Fi standard (operating at 60 GHz). That said, some embodiments may utilize RF sensing with frequencies outside this range. For example, in some embodiments, 5G NR frequency bands (e.g., 28 GHz) may be used. Because RF sensing may be performed in the same bands as communication, hardware may be utilized for both communication and RF sensing. For example, one or more of the components of an RF sensing system as described herein may be included in a wireless modem (e.g., Wi-Fi or NR modem), a UE (e.g., an extended device), or the like. Additionally, techniques may apply to RF signals comprising any of a variety of pulse types, including compressed pulses (e.g., comprising Chirp, Golay, Barker, or Ipatov sequences) may be utilized. That said, embodiments are not limited to such frequencies and/or pulse types. Additionally, because the RF sensing system may be capable of sending RF signals for communication (e.g., using 802.11 or NR wireless technology), embodiments may leverage channel estimation and/or other communication-related functions for providing RF sensing functionality as described herein. Accordingly, the pulses may be the same as those used in at least some aspects of wireless communication.

[0028] As noted, RF sensing may be performed by wireless devices or sensing nodes and can have a wide range of consumer, industrial, commercial, and other applications. As also noted, RF sensing may be performed in the same bands used for communication purposes and a wireless device (referred to henceforth as a user device) can include hardware and software that may be utilized for both communication and RF sensing. In an example operating environment, the user device may be constrained to operate within an assigned band of frequencies that is generally referred to herein as a bandwidth part (BWP). The use of BWPs may generally be directed at two aspects. A first aspect is bandwidth adaptation to help reduce device power consumption in a user device and a second aspect is to provide support for devices that utilize various bandwidths. More particularly, a user device may use a wide bandwidth when operating upon a large amount of data over some periods of time and may use a smaller bandwidth at some other periods of time. Power consumption may be reduced by allocating two different BWPs for use by the user device during these two periods of time. The BWP allocation can be carried out by a base station based on factors such as, for example, a channel bandwidth made available to the base station for BWP assignments and a number of user devices supported by the base station.

[0029] However, BWP allocation practices may fail to take into consideration differences between the capabilities of various types of user devices to perform various types of sensing functions. For example, a first user device may have a capability to perform high resolution sensing operations using wideband RF signals. A second user device may have a limited capability to perform sensing operations and may consequently use a narrower RF band. Allocating an identical BWP to both user devices for performing sensing functions can therefore be a sub-optimal approach.

Embodiments described herein address this aspect and other aspects based on the use of BWPs that can be flexibly allocated to various user devices based on individual capabilities of the user devices to perform sensing operations.

[0030] Furthermore, BWP allocation practices may also fail to take into consideration a capability of a user device for performing RF sensing functions in conjunction with communication functions. For example, a user device capable of only narrowband communications using a relatively small BWP may also be capable of high-resolution sensing using a relatively large BWP. Thus, in an example embodiment, a user device may be allocated an RF BWP for RF sensing that is larger than a baseband BWP used by the user device for communication operations. The user device can

perform a high-resolution sensing operation based on use of the allocated RF BWP either jointly while performing communication functions, or in an independent mode of operation when not performing communication operations.

[0031] Particular aspects of the subject matter described in this disclosure can be implemented to realize one or more of the following potential advantages. A first potential advantage can be associated with a method that can be used to configure a user device to utilize, what is referred to herein as an “RF BWP.” A request made by the user device to a configuring node (such as, for example, a base station) for allocation of the RF BWP may be based on the capabilities of the user device for performing sensing operations. In an example implementation, the user device may utilize the RF BWP for performing sensing operations at some times and may utilize what is referred to herein as a “baseband BWP” for communication purposes at some other times. The RF BWP is typically larger than the baseband BWP. A discussion of embodiments is provided below after a brief discussion of relevant technology and context/background in which embodiments may be used. It must be understood that the labels “sensing function” and “sensing function” are used herein in an interchangeable manner.

[0032] FIG. 1 is a simplified illustration of a positioning/sensing system **100**, which may be implemented in conjunction with and/or as part of a wireless communication system (e.g., cellular communication network) which includes a mobile device **105**, location/sensing server **160**, and/or other components of the positioning/sensing system **100** can use the techniques provided herein for requesting and obtaining support for an RF signal that can be used by the mobile device **105** for sensing purposes according to an embodiment. The techniques described herein may be implemented by one or more components of the positioning/sensing system **100**, however the techniques described herein are not limited to such components and may be implemented in other types of systems (not shown). The positioning/sensing system **100** can include: the mobile device **105**; one or more satellites **110** (also referred to as space vehicles (SVs)) for a Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) (such as the Global Positioning System (GPS), GLONASS, Galileo or Beidou) and/or Non-Terrestrial Network (NTN) functionality; base stations **120**; access points (APs) **130**; location/sensing server **160**; network **170**; and external client **180**. Generally put, the positioning/sensing system **100** can estimate a location of the mobile device **105** based on RF signals received by and/or sent from the mobile device **105** and known locations of other components (e.g., GNSS satellites **110**, base stations **120**, APs **130**) transmitting and/or receiving the RF signals. Additionally or alternatively, wireless devices such as the mobile device **105**, base stations **120**, and satellites **110** (and/or other NTN platforms, which may be implemented on airplanes, drones, balloons, etc.) can be utilized to perform positioning (e.g., of one or more wireless devices) and/or to perform RF sensing (e.g., of one or more objects by using RF signals transmitted by one or more wireless devices).

[0033] It should be noted that FIG. 1 provides only a generalized illustration of various components, any or all of which may be utilized as appropriate, and each of which may be duplicated, as necessary. Specifically, although only one mobile device **105** is illustrated, it will be understood that many UEs (e.g., hundreds, thousands, millions, etc.) may utilize the positioning/sensing system **100**. Similarly, the positioning/sensing system **100** may include a larger or smaller number of base stations **120** and/or APs **130** than illustrated in FIG. 1. The illustrated connections that connect the various components in the positioning/sensing system **100** comprise data and signaling connections which may include additional (intermediary) components, direct or indirect physical and/or wireless connections, and/or additional networks. Furthermore, components may be rearranged, combined, separated, substituted, and/or omitted, depending on desired functionality. In some embodiments, for example, the external client **180** may be directly connected to location/sensing server **160**. A person of ordinary skill in the art will recognize many modifications to the components illustrated.

[0034] Depending on desired functionality, the network **170** may comprise any of a variety of

wireless and/or wireline networks. The network **170** can, for example, comprise any combination of public and/or private networks, local and/or wide-area networks, and the like. Furthermore, the network **170** may utilize one or more wired and/or wireless communication technologies. In some embodiments, the network **170** may comprise a cellular or other mobile network, a wireless local area network (WLAN), a wireless wide-area network (WWAN), and/or the Internet, for example. Examples of network **170** include a Long-Term Evolution (LTE) wireless network, a Fifth Generation (5G) wireless network (also referred to as New Radio (NR) wireless network or 5G NR wireless network), a Wi-Fi WLAN, and the Internet. LTE, 5G, and NR are wireless technologies defined, or being defined, by the 3rd Generation Partnership Project (3GPP). In an LTE, 5G, or other cellular network, mobile device **105** may be referred to as a user equipment (UE). Network **170** may also include more than one network and/or more than one type of network.

[0035] The base stations **120** and access points (APs) **130** may be communicatively coupled to the network **170**. In some embodiments, the base stations **120** may be owned, maintained, and/or operated by a cellular network provider, and may employ any of a variety of wireless technologies, as described herein below. Depending on the technology of the network **170**, a base station **120** may comprise a node B, an Evolved Node B (eNodeB or eNB), a base transceiver station (BTS), a radio base station (RBS), a New Radio (NR) NodeB, a Next Generation Node B (gNB), a Next Generation eNB (ng-eNB), or the like. A base station **120** that is a gNB or ng-eNB may be part of a Next Generation Radio Access Network (NG-RAN) which may connect to a 5G Core Network (5GC) in the case that Network **170** is a 5G network. The functionality performed by a base station **120** in earlier-generation networks (e.g., 3G and 4G) may be separated into different functional components (e.g., radio units (RUs), distributed units (DUs), and central units (CUs)) and layers (e.g., L1/L2/L3) in view Open Radio Access Networks (O-RAN) and/or Virtualized Radio Access Network (V-RAN or vRAN) in 5G or later networks, which may be executed on different devices at different locations connected, for example, via fronthaul, midhaul, and backhaul connections. As referred to herein, a “base station” (or ng-eNB, gNB, etc.) may include any or all of these functional components.

[0036] An AP **130** may comprise a Wi-Fi AP or a Bluetooth® AP or an AP having cellular capabilities (e.g., 4G LTE and/or 5G NR), for example. Thus, mobile device **105** can send and receive information with network-connected devices, such as location/sensing server **160**, by accessing the network **170** via a base station **120** using a first communication link **133**. Additionally or alternatively, because APs **130** also may be communicatively coupled with the network **170**, mobile device **105** may communicate with network-connected and Internet-connected devices, including location/sensing server **160**, using a second communication link **135**, or via one or more other mobile devices **145**. As used herein, the term “base station” may generically refer to a single physical transmission point, or multiple co-located physical transmission points, which may be located at a base station **120**. A Transmission Reception Point (TRP) (also known as transmit/receive point) corresponds to this type of transmission point, and the term “TRP” may be used interchangeably herein with the terms “gNB,” “ng-eNB,” and “base station.” In some cases, a base station **120** may comprise multiple TRPs—e.g. with each TRP associated with a different antenna or a different antenna array for the base station **120**. As used herein, the transmission functionality of a TRP may be performed with a transmission point (TP) and/or the reception functionality of a TRP may be performed by a reception point (RP), which may be physically separate or distinct from a TP. That said, a TRP may comprise both a TP and an RP. Physical transmission points may comprise an array of antennas of a base station **120** (e.g., as in a Multiple Input-Multiple Output (MIMO) system and/or where the base station employs beamforming). According to aspects of applicable 5G cellular standards, a base station **120** (e.g., gNB) may be capable of transmitting different “beams” in different directions and performing “beam sweeping” in which a signal is transmitted in different beams, along different directions (e.g., one after the other). The term “base station” used herein may additionally refer to multiple non-co-located

physical transmission points, the physical transmission points may be a Distributed Antenna System (DAS) (a network of spatially separated antennas connected to a common source via a transport medium) or a Remote Radio Head (RRH) (a remote base station connected to a serving base station).

[0037] As noted, satellites **110** may be used to implement NTN functionality, extending communication, positioning, and potentially other functionality (e.g., RF sensing) of a terrestrial network. As such, one or more satellites may be communicatively linked to one or more NTN gateways **150** (also known as “gateways,” “earth stations,” or “ground stations”). The NTN gateways **150** may be communicatively linked with base stations **120** via link **155**. In some embodiments, NTN gateways **150** may function as DUs of a base station **120**, as described previously. Not only can this enable the mobile device **105** to communicate with the network **170** via satellites **110**, but this can also enable network-based positioning, RF sensing, etc.

[0038] Satellites **110** may be utilized in one or more way. For example, satellites **110** (also referred to as space vehicles (SVs)) may be part of a Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) such as the Global Positioning System (GPS), GLONASS, Galileo or Beidou. Positioning using RF signals from GNSS satellites may comprise measuring multiple GNSS signals at a GNSS receiver of the mobile device **105** to perform code-based and/or carrier-based positioning, which can be highly accurate. Additionally or alternatively, satellites **110** may be utilized for NTN-based positioning, in which satellites **110** may functionally operate as TRPs (or TPs) of a network (e.g., LTE and/or NR network) and may be communicatively coupled with network **170**. In particular, reference signals (e.g., PRS) transmitted by satellites **110** NTN-based positioning may be similar to those transmitted by base stations **120** and may be coordinated by a network function server that may operate as a location server. In some embodiments, satellites **110** used for NTN-based positioning may be different than those used for GNSS-based positioning. In some embodiments NTN nodes may include non-terrestrial vehicles such as airplanes, balloons, drones, etc., which may be in addition or as an alternative to NTN satellites. NTN satellites **110** and/or other NTN platforms may be further leveraged to perform RF sensing. As described in more detail hereafter, satellites may use a JCS symbol in an Orthogonal Frequency-Division Multiplexing (OFDM) waveform to allow both RF sensing and/or positioning, and communication.

[0039] As used herein, the term “cell” may generically refer to a logical communication entity used for communication with a base station **120** and may be associated with an identifier for distinguishing neighboring cells (e.g., a Physical Cell Identifier (PCID), a Virtual Cell Identifier (VCID)) operating via the same or a different carrier. In some examples, a carrier may support multiple cells, and different cells may be configured according to different protocol types (e.g., Machine-Type Communication (MTC), Narrowband Internet-of-Things (NB-IoT), Enhanced Mobile Broadband (eMBB), or others) that may provide access for different types of devices. In some cases, the term “cell” may refer to a portion of a geographic coverage area (e.g., a sector) over which the logical entity operates.

[0040] The location/sensing server **160** may comprise a server and/or other computing device configured to determine an estimated location of mobile device **105** and/or provide data (e.g., “assistance data”) to mobile device **105** to facilitate location measurement and/or location determination by mobile device **105**. According to some embodiments, location/sensing server **160** may comprise a Home Secure User Plane Location (SUPL) Location Platform (H-SLP), which may support the SUPL user plane (UP) location solution defined by the Open Mobile Alliance (OMA) and may support location services for mobile device **105** based on subscription information for mobile device **105** stored in location/sensing server **160**. In some embodiments, the location/sensing server **160** may comprise, a Discovered SLP (D-SLP) or an Emergency SLP (E-SLP). The location/sensing server **160** may also comprise an Enhanced Serving Mobile Location Center (E-SMLC) that supports location of mobile device **105** using a control plane (CP) location solution for LTE radio access by mobile device **105**. The location/sensing server **160** may further

comprise a Location Management Function (LMF) that supports location of mobile device **105** using a control plane (CP) location solution for NR or LTE radio access by mobile device **105**. [0041] In a CP location solution, signaling to control and manage the location of mobile device **105** may be exchanged between elements of network **170** and with mobile device **105** using existing network interfaces and protocols and as signaling from the perspective of network **170**. In a UP location solution, signaling to control and manage the location of mobile device **105** may be exchanged between location/sensing server **160** and mobile device **105** as data (e.g. data transported using the Internet Protocol (IP) and/or Transmission Control Protocol (TCP)) from the perspective of network **170**.

[0042] As previously noted (and discussed in more detail below), the estimated location of mobile device **105** may be based on measurements of RF signals sent from and/or received by the mobile device **105**. In particular, these measurements can provide information regarding the relative distance and/or angle of the mobile device **105** from one or more components in the positioning/sensing system **100** (e.g., satellites **110**, APs **130**, base stations **120**). The estimated location of the mobile device **105** can be estimated geometrically (e.g., using multiangulation and/or multilateration), based on the distance (range) and/or angle measurements, along with known position of the one or more components.

[0043] Additionally or alternatively, the location/sensing server **160**, may function as a sensing server. A sensing server can be used to coordinate and/or assist in the coordination of sensing of one or more objects (also referred to herein as “targets”) by one or more wireless devices in the positioning/sensing system **100**. This can include the mobile device **105**, base stations **120**, APs **130**, other mobile devices **145**, satellites **110**, or any combination thereof. Wireless devices capable of performing RF sensing may be referred to herein as “sensing nodes.” To perform RF sensing, a sensing server may coordinate sensing sessions in which one or more RF sensing nodes may perform RF sensing by transmitting RF signals (e.g., reference signals (RSs)), and measuring reflected signals, or “echoes,” comprising reflections of the transmitted RF signals off of one or more objects/targets. Reflected signals and object/target detection may be determined, for example, from channel state information (CSI) received at a receiving device. Sensing may comprise (i) monostatic sensing using a single device as a transmitter (of RF signals) and receiver (of reflected signals); (ii) bistatic sensing using a first device as a transmitter and a second device as a receiver; or (iii) multi-static sensing using a plurality of transmitters and/or a plurality of receivers. To facilitate sensing (e.g., in a sensing session among one or more sensing nodes), a sensing server may provide data (e.g., “assistance data”) to the sensing nodes to facilitate RS transmission and/or measurement, object/target detection, or any combination thereof. Such data may include an RS configuration indicating which resources (e.g., time and/or frequency resources) may be used (e.g., in a sensing session) to transmit RS for RF sensing. According to some embodiments, a sensing server may comprise a Sensing Management Function (SMF or SnMF).

[0044] Although terrestrial components such as APs **130** and base stations **120** may be fixed, embodiments are not so limited. Mobile components may be used. For example, in some embodiments, a location of the mobile device **105** may be estimated at least in part based on measurements of RF signals **140** communicated between the mobile device **105** and one or more other mobile devices **145**, which may be mobile or fixed. As illustrated, other mobile devices may include, for example, a mobile phone **145-1**, vehicle **145-2**, static communication/positioning device **145-3**, or other static and/or mobile device capable of providing wireless signals used for positioning the mobile device **105**, or a combination thereof. Wireless signals from mobile devices **145** used for positioning of the mobile device **105** may comprise RF signals using, for example, Bluetooth® (including Bluetooth Low Energy (BLE)), IEEE 802.11x (e.g., Wi-Fi®), Ultra-Wideband (UWB), IEEE 802.15x, or a combination thereof. Mobile devices **145** may additionally or alternatively use non-RF wireless signals for positioning of the mobile device **105**, such as infrared signals or other optical technologies.

[0045] Mobile devices **145** may comprise other UEs communicatively coupled with a cellular or other mobile network (e.g., network **170**). When one or more other mobile devices **145** comprising UEs are used in the position determination of a particular mobile device **105**, the mobile device **105** for which the position is to be determined may be referred to as the “target UE,” and each of the other mobile devices **145** used may be referred to as an “anchor UE.” For position determination of a target UE, the respective positions of the one or more anchor UEs may be known and/or jointly determined with the target UE. Direct communication between the one or more other mobile devices **145** and mobile device **105** may comprise sidelink and/or similar Device-to-Device (D2D) communication technologies. Sidelink, which is defined by 3GPP, is a form of D2D communication under the cellular-based LTE and NR standards.

[0046] According to some embodiments, such as when the mobile device **105** comprises and/or is incorporated into a vehicle, a form of D2D communication used by the mobile device **105** may comprise vehicle-to-everything (V2X) communication. V2X is a communication standard for vehicles and related entities to exchange information regarding a traffic environment. V2X can include vehicle-to-vehicle (V2V) communication between V2X-capable vehicles, vehicle-to-infrastructure (V2I) communication between the vehicle and infrastructure-based devices (commonly termed roadside units (RSUs)), vehicle-to-person (V2P) communication between vehicles and nearby people (pedestrians, cyclists, and other road users), and the like. Further, V2X can use any of a variety of wireless RF communication technologies. Cellular V2X (CV2X), for example, is a form of V2X that uses cellular-based communication such as LTE (4G), NR (5G) and/or other cellular technologies in a direct-communication mode as defined by 3GPP. The mobile device **105** illustrated in FIG. **1** may correspond to a component or device on a vehicle, RSU, or other V2X entity that is used to communicate V2X messages. In embodiments in which V2X is used, the static communication/positioning device **145-3** (which may correspond with an RSU) and/or the vehicle **145-2**, therefore, may communicate with the mobile device **105** and may be used to determine the position of the mobile device **105** using techniques similar to those used by base stations **120** and/or APs **130** (e.g., using multiangulation and/or multilateration). It can be further noted that mobile devices **145** (which may include V2X devices), base stations **120**, and/or APs **130** may be used together (e.g., in a WWAN positioning solution) to determine the position of the mobile device **105**, according to some embodiments.

[0047] An estimated location of mobile device **105** can be used in a variety of applications—e.g. to assist direction finding or navigation for a user of mobile device **105** or to assist another user (e.g. associated with external client **180**) to locate mobile device **105**. A “location” is also referred to herein as a “location estimate,” “estimated location,” “location,” “position,” “position estimate,” “position fix,” “estimated position,” “location fix” or “fix.” The process of determining a location may be referred to as “positioning,” “position determination,” “location determination,” or the like. A location of mobile device **105** may comprise an absolute location of mobile device **105** (e.g. a latitude and longitude and possibly altitude) or a relative location of mobile device **105** (e.g. a location expressed as distances north or south, east or west and possibly above or below some other known fixed location (including, e.g., the location of a base station **120** or AP **130**) or some other location such as a location for mobile device **105** at some known previous time, or a location of a mobile device **145** (e.g., another UE) at some known previous time). A location may be specified as a geodetic location comprising coordinates which may be absolute (e.g. latitude, longitude and optionally altitude), relative (e.g. relative to some known absolute location) or local (e.g. X, Y and optionally Z coordinates according to a coordinate system defined relative to a local area such a factory, warehouse, college campus, shopping mall, sports stadium or convention center). A location may instead be a civic location and may then comprise one or more of a street address (e.g. including names or labels for a country, state, county, city, road and/or street, and/or a road or street number), and/or a label or name for a place, building, portion of a building, floor of a building, and/or room inside a building etc. A location may further include an uncertainty or error indication,

such as a horizontal and possibly vertical distance by which the location is expected to be in error or an indication of an area or volume (e.g. a circle or ellipse) within which mobile device **105** is expected to be located with some level of confidence (e.g. 95% confidence).

[0048] The external client **180** may be a web server or remote application that may have some association with mobile device **105** (e.g. may be accessed by a user of mobile device **105**) or may be a server, application, or computer system providing a location service to some other user or users which may include obtaining and providing the location of mobile device **105** (e.g. to enable a service such as friend or relative finder, or child or pet location). Additionally or alternatively, the external client **180** may obtain and provide the location of mobile device **105** to an emergency services provider, government agency, etc.

[0049] As previously noted, the example positioning/sensing system **100** can be implemented using a wireless communication network, such as an LTE-based or 5G NR-based network, or a future 6G network.

[0050] FIG. **2** shows a diagram of a 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200**, illustrating an embodiment of a positioning/sensing system (e.g., positioning/sensing system **100**) implemented in 5G NR. The 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200** may be configured to enable wireless communication, determine the location of a UE **205** (which may correspond to the mobile device **105** of FIG. **1**), perform RF sensing, or a combination thereof, by using access nodes, which may include NR NodeB (gNB) **210-1** and **210-2** (collectively and generically referred to herein as gNBs **210**), ng-eNB **214**, and/or WLAN **216** to implement one or more positioning methods. These access nodes can use RF signaling to enable the communication, implement one or more positioning methods, and/or implement RF sensing. The gNBs **210** and/or the ng-eNB **214** may correspond with base stations **120** of FIG. **1**, and the WLAN **216** may correspond with one or more access points **130** of FIG. **1**. Optionally, the 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200** additionally may be configured to determine the location of a UE **205** by using an LMF **220** (which may correspond with location/sensing server **160**) to implement the one or more positioning methods. The SMF **221** may coordinate RF sensing by the 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200**. Here, the 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200** comprises a UE **205**, and components of a 5G NR network comprising a Next Generation (NG) Radio Access Network (RAN) (NG-RAN) **235** and a 5G Core Network (5G CN) **240**. A 5G network may also be referred to as an NR network; NG-RAN **235** may be referred to as a 5G RAN or as an NR RAN; and 5G CN **240** may be referred to as an NG Core network. Additional components of the 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200** are described below. The 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200** may include additional or alternative components.

[0051] The 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200** may further utilize information from satellites **110**. As previously indicated, satellites **110** may comprise GNSS satellites from a GNSS system like Global Positioning/sensing system (GPS) or similar system (e.g. GLONASS, Galileo, Beidou, Indian Regional Navigational Satellite System (IRNSS)). Additionally or alternatively, satellites **110** may comprise NTN satellites. NTN satellites may be in low earth orbit (LEO), medium earth orbit (MEO), geostationary earth orbit (GEO) or some other type of orbit. NTN satellites may be communicatively coupled with the LMF **220** and may operatively function as a TRP (or TP) in the NG-RAN **235**. As such, satellites **110** may be in communication with one or more gNBs **210** via one or more NTN gateways **150**. According to some embodiments, an NTN gateway **150** may operate as a DU of a gNB **210**, in which case communications between NTN gateway **150** and CU of the gNB **210** may occur over an F interface **218** between DU and CU.

[0052] It should be noted that FIG. **2** provides only a generalized illustration of various components, any or all of which may be utilized as appropriate, and each of which may be duplicated or omitted, as necessary. Specifically, although only one UE **205** is illustrated, it will be understood that many UEs (e.g., hundreds, thousands, millions, etc.) may utilize the 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200**. Similarly, the 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200** may include

a larger (or smaller) number of satellites **110**, gNBs **210**, ng-eNBs **214**, Wireless Local Area Networks (WLANs) **216**, Access and mobility Management Functions (AMF) s **215**, external clients **230**, and/or other components. The illustrated connections that connect the various components in the 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200** include data and signaling connections which may include additional (intermediary) components, direct or indirect physical and/or wireless connections, and/or additional networks. Furthermore, components may be rearranged, combined, separated, substituted, and/or omitted, depending on desired functionality.

[0053] The UE **205** may comprise and/or be referred to as a device, a mobile device, a wireless device, a mobile terminal, a terminal, a mobile station (MS), a Secure User Plane Location (SUPL)-Enabled Terminal (SET), or by some other name. Moreover, UE **205** may correspond to a cellphone, smartphone, laptop, tablet, personal data assistant (PDA), navigation device, Internet of Things (IoT) device, or some other portable or moveable device. Typically, though not necessarily, the UE **205** may support wireless communication using one or more Radio Access Technologies (RATs) such as using GSM, CDMA, W-CDMA, LTE, High-Rate Packet Data (HRPD), IEEE 802.11 Wi-Fi®, Bluetooth, Worldwide Interoperability for Microwave Access (WiMAX™), 5G NR (e.g., using the NG-RAN **235** and 5G CN **240**), etc. The UE **205** may also support wireless communication using a WLAN **216** which (like the one or more RATs, and as previously noted with respect to FIG. **1**) may connect to other networks, such as the Internet. The use of one or more of these RATs may allow the UE **205** to communicate with an external client **230** (e.g., via elements of 5G CN **240** not shown in FIG. **2**, or possibly via a Gateway Mobile Location Center (GMLC) **225**) and/or allow the external client **230** to receive location information regarding the UE **205** (e.g., via the GMLC **225**). The external client **230** of FIG. **2** may correspond to external client **180** of FIG. **1**, as implemented in or communicatively coupled with a 5G NR network.

[0054] The UE **205** may include a single entity or may include multiple entities, such as in a personal area network where a user may employ audio, video and/or data I/O devices, and/or body sensors and a separate wireline or wireless modem. An estimate of a location of the UE **205** may be referred to as a location, location estimate, location fix, fix, position, position estimate, or position fix, and may be geodetic, thus providing location coordinates for the UE **205** (e.g., latitude and longitude), which may or may not include an altitude component (e.g., height above sea level, height above or depth below ground level, floor level or basement level). Alternatively, a location of the UE **205** may be expressed as a civic location (e.g., as a postal address or the designation of some point or small area in a building such as a particular room or floor). A location of the UE **205** may also be expressed as an area or volume (defined either geodetically or in civic form) within which the UE **205** is expected to be located with some probability or confidence level (e.g., 67%, 95%, etc.). A location of the UE **205** may further be a relative location comprising, for example, a distance and direction or relative X, Y (and Z) coordinates defined relative to some origin at a known location which may be defined geodetically, in civic terms, or by reference to a point, area, or volume indicated on a map, floor plan or building plan. In the description contained herein, the use of the term location may comprise any of these variants unless indicated otherwise. When computing the location of a UE, it is common to solve for local X, Y, and possibly Z coordinates and then, if needed, convert the local coordinates into absolute ones (e.g. for latitude, longitude and altitude above or below mean sea level).

[0055] Base stations in the NG-RAN **235** shown in FIG. **2** may correspond to base stations **120** in FIG. **1** and may include gNBs **210**. Pairs of gNBs **210** in NG-RAN **235** may be connected to one another (e.g., directly as shown in FIG. **2** or indirectly via other gNBs **210**). The communication interface between base stations (gNBs **210** and/or ng-eNB **214**) may be referred to as an Xn interface **237**. Access to the 5G network is provided to UE **205** via wireless communication between the UE **205** and one or more of the gNBs **210**, which may provide wireless communications access to the 5G CN **240** on behalf of the UE **205** using 5G NR. The wireless interface between base stations (gNBs **210** and/or ng-eNB **214**) and the UE **205** may be referred to

as a Uu interface **239**. 5G NR radio access may also be referred to as NR radio access or as 5G radio access. In FIG. 2, the serving gNB for UE **205** is assumed to be gNB **210-1**, although other gNBs (e.g. gNB **210-2**) may act as a serving gNB if UE **205** moves to another location or may act as a secondary gNB to provide additional throughput and bandwidth to UE **205**.

[0056] Base stations in the NG-RAN **235** shown in FIG. 2 may also or instead include a next generation evolved Node B, also referred to as an ng-eNB, **214**. Ng-eNB **214** may be connected to one or more gNBs **210** in NG-RAN **235**—e.g. directly or indirectly via other gNBs **210** and/or other ng-eNBs. An ng-eNB **214** may provide LTE wireless access and/or evolved LTE (eLTE) wireless access to UE **205**. Some gNBs **210** (e.g. gNB **210-2**) and/or ng-eNB **214** in FIG. 2 may be configured to function as positioning-only beacons which may transmit signals (e.g., Positioning Reference Signal (PRS)) and/or may broadcast assistance data to assist positioning of UE **205** but may not receive signals from UE **205** or from other UEs. Some gNBs **210** (e.g., gNB **210-2** and/or another gNB not shown) and/or ng-eNB **214** may be configured to function as detecting-only nodes may scan for signals containing, e.g., PRS data, assistance data, or other location data. Such detecting-only nodes may not transmit signals or data to UEs but may transmit signals or data (relating to, e.g., PRS, assistance data, or other location data) to other network entities (e.g., one or more components of 5G CN **240**, external client **230**, or a controller) which may receive and store or use the data for positioning of at least UE **205**. It is noted that while only one ng-eNB **214** is shown in FIG. 2, some embodiments may include multiple ng-eNBs **214**. Base stations (e.g., gNBs **210** and/or ng-eNB **214**) may communicate directly with one another via an Xn communication interface. Additionally or alternatively, base stations may communicate directly or indirectly with other components of the 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200**, such as the LMF **220** and AMF **215**.

[0057] 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200** may also include one or more WLANs **216** which may connect to a Non-3GPP InterWorking Function (N3IWF) **250** in the 5G CN **240** (e.g., in the case of an untrusted WLAN **216**). For example, the WLAN **216** may support IEEE 802.11 Wi-Fi access for UE **205** and may comprise one or more Wi-Fi APs (e.g., APs **130** of FIG. 1). Here, the N3IWF **250** may connect to other elements in the 5G CN **240** such as AMF **215**. In some embodiments, WLAN **216** may support another RAT such as Bluetooth. The N3IWF **250** may provide support for secure access by UE **205** to other elements in 5G CN **240** and/or may support interworking of one or more protocols used by WLAN **216** and UE **205** to one or more protocols used by other elements of 5G CN **240** such as AMF **215**. For example, N3IWF **250** may support IPsec tunnel establishment with UE **205**, termination of IKEv2/IPsec protocols with UE **205**, termination of N2 and N3 interfaces to 5G CN **240** for control plane and user plane, respectively, relaying of uplink (UL) and downlink (DL) control plane Non-Access Stratum (NAS) signaling between UE **205** and AMF **215** across an N1 interface. In some other embodiments, WLAN **216** may connect directly to elements in 5G CN **240** (e.g. AMF **215** as shown by the dashed line in FIG. 2) and not via N3IWF **250**. For example, direct connection of WLAN **216** to 5GCN **240** may occur if WLAN **216** is a trusted WLAN for 5GCN **240** and may be enabled using a Trusted WLAN Interworking Function (TWIF) (not shown in FIG. 2) which may be an element inside WLAN **216**. It is noted that while only one WLAN **216** is shown in FIG. 2, some embodiments may include multiple WLANs **216**.

[0058] Access nodes may comprise any of a variety of network entities enabling communication between the UE **205** and the AMF **215**. As noted, this can include gNBs **210**, ng-eNB **214**, WLAN **216**, and/or other types of cellular base stations, and may also include NTN satellites **110**. However, access nodes providing the functionality described herein may additionally or alternatively include entities enabling communications to any of a variety of RATs not illustrated in FIG. 2, which may include non-cellular technologies. Thus, the term “access node,” as used in the embodiments described herein below, may include but is not necessarily limited to a gNB **210**, ng-eNB **214**, WLAN **216**, or NTN satellite **110**.

[0059] In some embodiments, an access node, such as a gNB **210**, ng-eNB **214**, WLAN **216**, or NTN satellite **110**, or a combination thereof, (alone or in combination with other components of the 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200**), may be configured to, in response to receiving a request for location information from the LMF **220**, obtain location measurements of uplink (UL) signals received from the UE **205** and/or obtain downlink (DL) location measurements from the UE **205** that were obtained by UE **205** for DL signals received by UE **205** from one or more access nodes. As noted, while FIG. 2 depicts access nodes (gNB **210**, ng-eNB **214**, WLAN **216**, and NTN satellite **110**) configured to communicate according to 5G NR, LTE, and Wi-Fi communication protocols, respectively, access nodes configured to communicate according to other communication protocols may be used, such as, for example, a Node B using a Wideband Code Division Multiple Access (WCDMA) protocol for a Universal Mobile Telecommunications Service (UMTS) Terrestrial Radio Access Network (UTRAN), an eNB using an LTE protocol for an Evolved UTRAN (E-UTRAN), or a Bluetooth® beacon using a Bluetooth protocol for a WLAN. For example, in a 4G Evolved Packet System (EPS) providing LTE wireless access to UE **205**, a RAN may comprise an E-UTRAN, which may comprise base stations comprising eNBs supporting LTE wireless access. A core network for EPS may comprise an Evolved Packet Core (EPC). An EPS may then comprise an E-UTRAN plus an EPC, where the E-UTRAN corresponds to NG-RAN **235** and the EPC corresponds to 5GCN **240** in FIG. 2. The methods and techniques described herein for obtaining a civic location for UE **205** may be applicable to such other networks.

[0060] The gNBs **210** and ng-eNB **214** can communicate with an AMF **215**, which, for positioning functionality, communicates with an LMF **220**. The AMF **215** may support mobility of the UE **205**, including cell change and handover of UE **205** from an access node (e.g., gNB **210**, ng-eNB **214**, WLAN **216**, or NTN satellite **110**) of a first RAT to an access node of a second RAT. The AMF **215** may also participate in supporting a signaling connection to the UE **205** and possibly data and voice bearers for the UE **205**. The LMF **220** may support positioning of the UE **205** using a CP location solution when UE **205** accesses the NG-RAN **235** or WLAN **216** and may support position procedures and methods, including UE assisted/UE based and/or network based procedures/methods, such as Assisted GNSS (A-GNSS), Observed Time Difference Of Arrival (OTDOA) (which may be referred to in NR as Time Difference Of Arrival (TDOA)), Frequency Difference Of Arrival (FDOA), Real Time Kinematic (RTK), Precise Point Positioning (PPP), Differential GNSS (DGNSS), Enhance Cell ID (ECID), angle of arrival (AoA), angle of departure (AoD), WLAN positioning, round trip signal propagation delay (RTT), multi-cell RTT, and/or other positioning procedures and methods. The LMF **220** may also process location service requests for the UE **205**, e.g., received from the AMF **215** or from the GMLC **225**. The LMF **220** may be connected to AMF **215** and/or to GMLC **225**. In some embodiments, a network such as 5GCN **240** may additionally or alternatively implement other types of location-support modules, such as an Evolved Serving Mobile Location Center (E-SMLC) or a SUPL Location Platform (SLP). It is noted that in some embodiments, at least part of the positioning functionality (including determination of a location of the UE **205**) may be performed at the UE **205** (e.g., by measuring downlink PRS (DL-PRS) signals transmitted by wireless nodes such as gNB **210**, ng-eNB **214**, WLAN **216**, or NTN satellite **110**, and/or using assistance data provided to the UE **205**, e.g., by LMF **220**).

[0061] The Gateway Mobile Location Center (GMLC) **225** may support a location request for the UE **205** received from an external client **230** and may forward such a location request to the AMF **215** for forwarding by the AMF **215** to the LMF **220**. A location response from the LMF **220** (e.g., containing a location estimate for the UE **205**) may be similarly returned to the GMLC **225** either directly or via the AMF **215**, and the GMLC **225** may then return the location response (e.g., containing the location estimate) to the external client **230**.

[0062] A Network Exposure Function (NEF) **245** may be included in 5GCN **240**. The NEF **245** may support secure exposure of capabilities and events concerning 5GCN **240** and UE **205** to the

external client **230**, which may then be referred to as an Access Function (AF) and may enable the secure provision of information from the external client **230** to 5GCN **240**. NEF **245** may be connected to AMF **215** and/or to GMLC **225** for the purposes of obtaining a location (e.g. a civic location) of UE **205** and providing the location to external client **230**.

[0063] As further illustrated in FIG. 2, the LMF **220** may communicate with the gNBs **210** and/or with the ng-eNB **214** using an NR Positioning Protocol annex (NRPPa) as defined in 3GPP Technical Specification (TS) **38.455**. NRPPa messages may be transferred between a gNB **210** and the LMF **220**, and/or between an ng-eNB **214** and the LMF **220**, via the AMF **215**. As further illustrated in FIG. 2, LMF **220** and UE **205** may communicate using an LTE Positioning Protocol (LPP) as defined in 3GPP TS 37.355. Here, LPP messages may be transferred between the UE **205** and the LMF **220** via the AMF **215** and a serving gNB **210-1** or serving ng-eNB **214** for UE **205**. For example, LPP messages may be transferred between the LMF **220** and the AMF **215** using messages for service-based operations (e.g., based on the Hypertext Transfer Protocol (HTTP)) and may be transferred between the AMF **215** and the UE **205** using a 5G NAS protocol. The LPP protocol may be used to support positioning of UE **205** using UE assisted and/or UE-based position methods such as A-GNSS, RTK, TDOA, multi-cell RTT, AoD, and/or ECID. The NRPPa protocol may be used to support positioning of UE **205** using network-based position methods such as ECID, AoA, uplink TDOA (UL-TDOA) and/or may be used by LMF **220** to obtain location-related information from gNBs **210** and/or ng-eNB **214**, such as parameters defining DL-PRS transmission from gNBs **210** and/or ng-eNB **214**.

[0064] In the case of UE **205** access to WLAN **216**, LMF **220** may use NRPPa and/or LPP to obtain a location of UE **205** in a similar manner to that just described for UE **205** access to a gNB **210** or ng-eNB **214**. Thus, NRPPa messages may be transferred between a WLAN **216** and the LMF **220**, via the AMF **215** and N3IWF **250** to support network-based positioning of UE **205** and/or transfer of other location information from WLAN **216** to LMF **220**. Alternatively, NRPPa messages may be transferred between N3IWF **250** and the LMF **220**, via the AMF **215**, to support network-based positioning of UE **205** based on location-related information and/or location measurements known to or accessible to N3IWF **250** and transferred from N3IWF **250** to LMF **220** using NRPPa. Similarly, LPP and/or LPP messages may be transferred between the UE **205** and the LMF **220** via the AMF **215**, N3IWF **250**, and serving WLAN **216** for UE **205** to support UE-assisted or UE-based positioning of UE **205** by LMF **220**.

[0065] In a 5G NR positioning/sensing system **200**, positioning and sensing methods can be categorized as being “UE assisted” or “UE based.” This may depend on where the request for determining the position of the UE **205** originated. If, for example, the request originated at the UE (e.g., from an application, or “app,” executed by the UE), the positioning method may be categorized as being UE based. If, on the other hand, the request originates from an external client **230**, LMF **220**, or other device or service within the 5G network, the positioning method may be categorized as being UE assisted (or “network-based”).

[0066] With a UE-assisted position method, UE **205** may obtain location measurements and send the measurements to a location server (e.g., LMF **220**) for computation of a location estimate for UE **205**. For RAT-dependent position methods location measurements may include one or more of a Received Signal Strength Indicator (RSSI), Round Trip signal propagation Time (RTT), Reference Signal Received Power (RSRP), Reference Signal Received Quality (RSRQ), RSTD, Time of Arrival (TOA), AoA, Receive Time-Transmission Time Difference (Rx-Tx), Differential AoA (DAOA), AoD, or Timing Advance (TA) for gNBs **210**, ng-eNB **214**, and/or one or more access points for WLAN **216**. Additionally or alternatively, similar measurements may be made of sidelink signals transmitted by other UEs, which may serve as anchor points for positioning of the UE **205** if the positions of the other UEs are known. The location measurements may also or instead include measurements for RAT-independent positioning methods such as GNSS (e.g., GNSS pseudorange, GNSS code phase, and/or GNSS carrier phase for GNSS satellites), WLAN,

etc.

[0067] With a UE-based position method, UE **205** may obtain location measurements (e.g., which may be the same as or similar to location measurements for a UE-assisted position method) and may further compute a location of UE **205** (e.g., with the help of assistance data received from a location server such as LMF **220**, an SLP, or broadcast by gNBs **210**, ng-eNB **214**, or WLAN **216**).

[0068] With a network-based position method, one or more base stations (e.g., gNBs **210** and/or ng-eNB **214**), one or more APs (e.g., in WLAN **216**), or N3IWF **250** may obtain location measurements (e.g., measurements of RSSI, RTT, RSRP, RSRQ, AoA, or TOA) for signals transmitted by UE **205**, and/or may receive measurements obtained by UE **205** or by an AP in WLAN **216** in the case of N3IWF **250**, and may send the measurements to a location server (e.g., LMF **220**) for computation of a location estimate for UE **205**.

[0069] Positioning of the UE **205** also may be categorized as UL, DL, or DL-UL based, depending on the types of signals used for positioning. If, for example, positioning is based solely on signals received at the UE **205** (e.g., from a base station or other UE), the positioning may be categorized as DL based. On the other hand, if positioning is based solely on signals transmitted by the UE **205** (which may be received by a base station or other UE, for example), the positioning may be categorized as UL based. Positioning that is DL-UL based includes positioning, such as RTT-based positioning, which is based on signals that are both transmitted and received by the UE **205**.

Sidelink (SL)-assisted positioning comprises signals communicated between the UE **205** and one or more other UEs. According to some embodiments, UL, DL, or DL-UL positioning as described herein may be capable of using SL signaling as a complement or replacement of SL, DL, or DL-UL signaling.

[0070] Depending on the type of positioning (e.g., UL, DL, or DL-UL based) the types of reference signals used can vary. For DL-based positioning, for example, these signals may comprise PRS (e.g., DL-PRS transmitted by base stations or SL-PRS transmitted by other UEs), which can be used for TDOA, AoD, and RTT measurements. Other reference signals that can be used for positioning (UL, DL, or DL-UL) may include Sounding Reference Signal (SRS), Channel State Information Reference Signal (CSI-RS), synchronization signals (e.g., synchronization signal block (SSB) Synchronizations Signal (SS)), Physical Uplink Control Channel (PUCCH), Physical Uplink Shared Channel (PUSCH), Physical Sidelink Shared Channel (PSSCH), Demodulation Reference Signal (DMRS), etc. Moreover, reference signals may be transmitted in a Tx beam and/or received in an Rx beam (e.g., using beamforming techniques), which may impact angular measurements, such as AoD and/or AoA.

[0071] The principles described above with respect to UE-assisted positioning, UE-based positioning, UL-based positioning, DL-based positioning, and DL-UL based positioning may be generally extended to RF sensing. That is, RF sensing may be UE-based (e.g., originated from the UE) and/or UE assisted (e.g., originated from a non-UE entity), and may involve UL signals, DL signals, or both. However, RF sensing may differ from positioning in various ways. For example, as previously noted, RF sensing may involve the use of positioning reference signal (PRS), sounding reference signal (SRS), synchronization signal block (SSB), channel state information reference signal (CSI-RS), or any combination thereof. Further, RF sensing may be performed in a monostatic, bistatic, or multi-static manner, as described above, where RF sensing nodes comprise a UE (e.g., UE **205**) and/or one or more access nodes (e.g., gNBs **210**, ng-eNB **214**, WLAN **216**, NTN satellites **110**, or any combination thereof). Various aspects of RF sensing are described below FIG in more detail with respect to FIG. **3**.

[0072] FIG. **3** is a diagram showing an example of an RF sensing system **305** and associated terminology. As used herein, the terms “waveform” and “sequence” and derivatives thereof are used interchangeably to refer to RF signals generated by a transmitter of the RF sensing system and received by a receiver of the RF sensing system for object detection. A “pulse” and derivatives thereof are generally referred to herein as waveforms comprising a sequence or complementary

pair of sequences transmitted and received to generate a channel impulse response (CIR). The RF sensing system **305** may comprise a standalone device or may be integrated into a larger electronic device such as, for example, the UE **205** described above. It can be noted that although the example RF sensing system **305** of FIG. **3** is illustrated in a monostatic configuration, embodiments are not so limited. As noted elsewhere herein, RF sensing nodes may be configured to perform RF sensing in a monostatic, bistatic, or multi-static configuration, or any combination thereof (e.g., depending on the circumstances of a particular instance). As such, components of an RF sensing system **305** within an RF sensing node may vary. For example, RF sensing nodes performing only transmitting or only receiving during RF sensing may include only respective components related to the transmitting or receiving. Again, embodiments may vary, depending on desired functionality.

[0073] With regard to the functionality of the RF sensing system **305** in FIG. **3**, the RF sensing system **305** can detect the distance, direction, and/or speed of objects of an object **310** by generating a series of transmitted RF signals **312** (comprising one or more pulses). Some of these transmitted RF signals **312** reflect off of the object **310**, and these reflected RF signals **314** (or “echoes”) are then processed by the RF sensing system **305** using beamforming (BF) and digital signal processing (DSP) techniques to determine the object's location (azimuth, elevation, velocity (e.g., from Doppler measurements), and range) relative to the RF sensing system **305**.

[0074] To enable RF sensing, RF sensing system **305** may include a processing unit **315**, memory **317**, multiplexer (mux) **320**, Tx processing circuitry **325**, and Rx processing circuitry **330**. (The RF sensing system **305** may include additional components not illustrated, such as a power source, user interface, or electronic interface). It can be noted, however, that these components of the RF sensing system **305** may be rearranged or otherwise altered in alternative embodiments, depending on desired functionality. Moreover, as used herein, the terms “transmit circuitry” or “Tx circuitry” refer to any circuitry utilized to create and/or transmit the transmitted RF signal **312**. Likewise, the terms “receive circuitry” or “Rx circuitry” refer to any circuitry utilized to detect and/or process the reflected RF signal **314**. As such, “transmit circuitry” and “receive circuitry” may not only comprise the Tx processing circuitry **325** and Rx processing circuitry **330** respectively but may also comprise the mux **320** and processing unit **315**. In some embodiments, the processing unit may compose at least part of a modem and/or wireless communications interface. In some embodiments, more than one processing unit may be used to perform the functions of the processing unit **315** described herein.

[0075] The Tx processing circuitry **325** and Rx circuitry **330** may comprise subcomponents for respectively generating and detecting RF signals. As a person of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate, the Tx processing circuitry **325** may therefore include a pulse generator, digital-to-analog converter (DAC), a mixer (for up-mixing the signal to the transmit frequency), one or more amplifiers (for powering the transmission via Tx antenna array **335**), etc. The Rx processing circuitry **330** may have similar hardware for processing a detected RF signal. In particular, the Rx processing circuitry **330** may comprise an amplifier (for amplifying a signal received via Rx antenna array **340**), a mixer configured to perform FMCW demodulation, a filter to block undesired signals in the mixer output, an analog-to-digital converter (ADC) for digitizing the demodulated signal, and a pulse correlator providing a matched filter for the pulse generated by the Tx processing circuitry **325**. The Rx processing circuitry **330** may therefore use the correlator output as the CIR, which can be processed by the processing unit **315** (or other circuitries). Processing of the CIR may include object detecting, range, speed, or direction of arrival (DoA) estimation.

[0076] Beamforming is further enabled by a Tx antenna array **335** and an Rx antenna array **340**. Each antenna array **335**, **340** comprises a plurality of antenna elements. It can be noted that, although the antenna arrays **335**, **340** of FIG. **3** include two-dimensional arrays, embodiments are not so limited. Arrays may simply include a plurality of antenna elements along a single dimension that provides for spatial cancellation between the Tx and Rx sides of the RF sensing system **305**. As a person of ordinary skill in the art will appreciate, the relative location of the Tx and Rx sides, in

addition to various environmental factors can impact how spatial cancellation may be performed. [0077] It can be noted that the properties of the transmitted RF signal **312** may vary, depending on the technologies utilized. Techniques provided herein can apply generally to “mm Wave” technologies, which typically operate at 57-71 GHz, but may include frequencies ranging from 30-300 GHz. This includes, for example, frequencies utilized by the 802.11ad Wi-Fi standard (operating at 60 GHz). That said, some embodiments may utilize RF signals with frequencies outside this range. For example, in some embodiments, 5G frequency bands (e.g., 28 GHz) may be used.

[0078] Because RF sensing may be performed in the same frequency bands as communication (e.g., cellular and/or WLAN communication), hardware may be utilized for both communication and RF sensing, as previously noted. For example, one or more of the components of the RF sensing system **305** shown in FIG. 3 may be included in a wireless modem (e.g., Wi-Fi, 5G, or other modems). Additionally, techniques may apply to RF signals comprising any of a variety of pulse types, including compressed pulses (e.g., comprising Chirp, Golay, Barker, or Ipatov sequences) may be utilized. That said, embodiments are not limited to such frequencies and/or pulse types. Additionally, because the RF sensing system may be capable of sending RF signals for communication (e.g., using 802.11 communication technology), embodiments may leverage channel estimation used in communication for performing the RF sensing as provided herein.

Accordingly, the pulses may be the same as those used for channel estimation in communication. [0079] As noted, the RF sensing system **305** may be integrated into an electronic device in which RF sensing is desired. For example, the RF sensing system **305**, which can perform RF sensing, may be part of communication hardware found in modern mobile phones. Other devices, too, may utilize the techniques provided herein. These can include, for example, other mobile devices (e.g., tablets, portable media players, laptops, wearable devices, other electronic devices (e.g., security devices, on-vehicle systems, specialized or dedicated RF sensing devices), wireless nodes of the communication network (e.g., access nodes, such as base stations and/or satellites), or the like. That said, electronic devices (e.g., RF sensing nodes) into which an RF sensing system **305** may be integrated are not limited to such devices.

[0080] In RF sensing, a wireless signal can be transmitted from one or multiple transmit points and received at one or multiple receive points after being reflected off a target. RF sensing can enable many candidate applications, including intruder detection, animal/pedestrian/unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) intrusion detection in highways and railways, rainfall monitoring, flooding awareness, autonomous driving, automated guided vehicle (AGV) detection/tracking/collision avoidance, smart parking and assistance, UAV trajectory and tracking, crowd management, sleep/health monitoring, gesture recognition, XR streaming, public safety, search and rescue, and more. Further, RF sensing is expected to be incorporated into wireless standards (e.g., 6G), and therefore may be performed in the future in a cellular network.

[0081] FIG. 4 is a diagram showing some example functional elements of the UE **205** described above. The example elements include an RF sensing system **405** and a communication system **455**. The RF sensing system **405** can include some or all of the components described above with reference to the RF sensing system **305** and can be used to perform various functions such as those described with reference to the RF sensing system **305**, particularly, the Rx processing circuitry **330**.

[0082] In the illustrated example, the RF sensing system **405**, which is shown configured to perform a sensing operation, includes a sensing circuit **425** and an analog-to-digital converter (ADC) **415**. The sensing circuit **425** can include, for example, an amplifier (for amplifying the reflected RF signal received from a sensing target via Rx antenna array **340**), a mixer configured to perform FMCW demodulation, a filter to block undesired signals in the mixer output, and other components for conditioning and processing the signal. In an example embodiment, the sensing circuit **425** is configured to operate in an FMCW mode of operation wherein a wideband RF signal

is converted into an analog demodulated signal occupying a bandwidth that is narrower than the RF bandwidth. The demodulation may be performed, for example, by use of a mixer and a FMCW local oscillator (LO). The narrowband demodulated signal (analog) can be coupled into the ADC **415** for digitizing. The output of the ADC **415** is in a digital format and can contain information related to, for example, detection of an object, a distance/range/angle at which the object is detected, a speed of movement of the object (if moving), and/or a direction of arrival (DoA) estimation. The information may be operated upon by other components that can include, for example, the processing unit **315** described above.

[0083] The ADC **415** in this arrangement can be a low-speed ADC that receives the demodulated signal occupying a narrow bandwidth in lieu of a high-speed ADC that may be used in a conventional arrangement in which the high-speed ADC is configured to operate directly upon a wideband reflected RF signal received from a sensing target. The use of a low-speed ADC having a low sampling rate provides various advantages in accordance with the disclosure, such as, for example, advantages associated with costs, complexity, and power consumption. The processing performed upon the output of the ADC **415** can include Fast Fourier Transform operations. Timing factors associated with the analog-to-digital conversion by the ADC **415** and the Fast Fourier Transform operations performed upon the digitized output of the ADC **415** generally characterize operations of the RF sensing system **405** in the FMCW domain. These timing factors may be used for various purposes such as, for example, to optimize power consumption, to define switching requirements between FMCW domain operations associated with sensing procedures and OFDM operations associated with communication procedures, and to ensure interoperability between the UE **205** and other equipment.

[0084] The communication system **455** can be used for communications purposes such as, for example, communications between the UE **205** and one or more components of the NG-RAN **235** and/or between the UE **205** and the WLAN **216** (shown in FIG. 2). In various embodiments, the communication system **455** can be operated concurrently with the RF sensing system **405** for performing communications and RF sensing operations concurrently. Such concurrent operations, which can also be referred to as joint operations, may be particularly applicable to joint communication and sensing (JCS) operations performed by sixth-generation (6G) systems. In the illustrated example, the communication system **455** includes a communication circuit **450** configured to operate in an orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) mode of operation. An input to the communication circuit **450** is a downstream RF signal occupying a baseband bandwidth. The baseband bandwidth has already been predefined in current practice and can be referred to alternatively as a legacy bandwidth.

[0085] In an example use case, the baseband bandwidth can be, for example, 400 MHz. In an example usage scenario, such as, for example, in a 6G system, the RF bandwidth associated with the RF signal used by the RF sensing system **405** for sensing purposes can be larger than the baseband bandwidth. In an example use case, the RF BWP can be much larger than the baseband bandwidth such as, for example, 1 GHz.

[0086] The communication output of the communication circuit **450** can be provided to components such as, for example, the processing unit **315** described above. In an example implementation, the communication system **455** can also be used to communicate with a configuration node such as, for example, a component of the NG-RAN **235** and/or a component of the 5G core network **240** shown in FIG. 2. The communications can be directed, for example, at requesting and obtaining support for the RF bandwidth used by the RF sensing system **405**. In an example implementation, the support may be provided to UE **205** by a configuring node in the form of configuration information such as, for example, a message indicating allocation of a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) to the UE **205**.

[0087] As described above, a wideband RF signal can be used for performing a sensing operation by the UE **205**. The use of a wideband RF signal for sensing purposes provides various advantages

over an RF signal occupying a smaller bandwidth such as, for example, by providing higher precision information associated with a sensing target (location, range, angle, direction, orientation, Doppler, velocity, etc.).

[0088] According to embodiments described herein, the RF BWP of the wideband RF signal can be flexibly defined and can vary from UE to UE in terms of use and/or in terms of capabilities of a UE. Thus, for example, a first UE may be configured to operate with a first RF BWP for performing a first type of sensing operation and reconfigured to operate with a second RF BWP for performing a second type of sensing operation at a different time. The second RF BWP may be smaller than the first RF BWP when the second type of sensing operation does not require the same level of performance as the first type of sensing operation, and vice-versa.

[0089] A second UE may be configured to operate with a third RF BWP that is, for example, smaller than the first BWP and/or the second RF BWP used by the first UE because the second UE is configured to perform, or is capable of performing, a third type of sensing operation that does not require the same level of performance as the first and/or second type of sensing operations performed by the first UE.

[0090] Interoperability between a UE and a network device such as, for example, an access device, can be dependent upon configuring the UE and the network device to be compatible with each other for supporting operations based on a specified RF BWP for sensing operations performed by the UE. For example, interoperability of the UE **205** and gNB **210** (as illustrated in FIG. **2**) can be dependent upon the UE **205** informing the gNB **210** of a capability and/or desirability of the UE **205** to utilize a specified RF bandwidth for sensing operations performed by the UE **205** and the gNB **210** acknowledging the information, allocating an RF BWP, and configuring the gNB **210** to interact with the UE **205** on the basis of the RF BWP. Further details pertaining to this aspect are described below.

[0091] FIG. **5** is a flow diagram **500** showing information exchange between a UE and a configuring node to enable the UE to utilize an RF BWP in accordance with an embodiment of the disclosure. The information exchange can be performed in various ways and by use of various formats. In an example embodiment, at least a portion of the information exchange can be conducted by use of a radio resource control (RRC) protocol.

[0092] The UE **510** and the configuring node **505** can be the UE **205** and the gNB **210** respectively, as shown in FIG. **2** and the communications between the UE **510** and the configuring node **505** may be carried out, for example, by means of the Uu interface **239** shown in FIG. **2**. The information exchange between the UE **510** and the configuring node **505** may begin with the functionality indicated by arrow **515**, in which the UE **510** transmits to the configuring node **505**, capability information of the UE **510**.

[0093] In an example embodiment, the capability information can include an indication of a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the UE **510** for performing sensing functions. For example, a first type of UE **510** may have a capability to perform high resolution sensing operations using wideband RF signals and may inform the configuring node **505** of the capability of the first user device to use a wideband RF bandwidth that is suitable for performing the high resolution sensing operations. A second type of UE **510** may have a limited capability to perform sensing operations and may inform the configuring node **505** of the capability of the second type of UE **510** to use a limited RF bandwidth that is adequate for performing these sensing operations.

[0094] In an example implementation, the radio frequency (RF) bandwidth indicated in the capability information transmitted by the UE **510** to the configuring node **505** can be determined based on the capabilities of RF sensing system **405** shown in FIG. **4** (FMCW capability of the sensing circuit **425**, sampling rate of ADC **415**, and FFT operations).

[0095] In another example embodiment, the functionality indicated by arrow **515** can involve the UE **510** transmitting to the configuring node **505**, a request for allocation of an RF BWP specified by the UE **510**, in lieu of, or in addition to, the RF bandwidth indicated in the capability

information described above. In this scenario, the configuring node **505** may consider the request based on one or more factors such as, for example, a channel bandwidth made available to the base station for BWP assignments and a number of user devices supported by the base station. The requested RF BWP may be specified, for example, by a user of the UE **510** based on a first sensing operation that is expected to be performed by the UE **510** and may be subsequently modified for a different sensing operation.

[0096] In another example embodiment, the functionality indicated by arrow **515** can involve the UE **510** transmitting to the configuring node **505**, information pertaining to one or more switch times associated with the UE **510**. A “switch time” may also be referred to herein as a “switching delay.” In one case, the switch time(s) information may be transmitted to the configuring node **505** as a part of the capability information described above. A first example of a switch time pertains to an amount of time that the UE **510** takes (switching delay) to switch from using an RF BWP (for sensing operations) to using a baseband BWP (for communication purposes).

[0097] The switch time may be determined based on transitioning from an FMCW mode of operation (using the RF BWP and FMCW numerologies) to an OFDM mode of operation (using the baseband BWP and OFDM numerologies). The FMCW mode of operation may use one or more symbol durations that are different than those used in OFDM operations (legacy operations).

[0098] A second example of a switch time pertains to an amount of time that the UE **510** takes to switch from using the baseband BWP to an RF BWP. The switch time, which may be determined based on transitioning from an OFDM mode of operation to an FMCW mode of operation can be different than the switch time described above (switching from FMCW to OFDM).

[0099] A third example of a switch time pertains to an amount of time that the UE **510** takes for switching from using a first RF BWP to a second RF BWP. In this case, the switch time may be based on FMCW numerologies associated with the first RF BWP and the second RF BWP.

[0100] The configuring node **505** evaluates the capability information and/or the requested BWP received from the UE **510** and allocates one or more BWPs to the UE **510**. In an example implementation, the configuring node **505** may be configured to support the UE **510** to perform concurrent processing of FMCW waveforms and OFDM waveforms based on a RF BWP and a baseband BWP respectively. In another example implementation, the configuring node **505** may be unable to support concurrent processing of FMCW waveforms and OFDM waveforms by the UE **510**, and may consequently, support the UE **510** perform operations upon only one of the FMCW waveforms or the OFDM waveforms over any selected periods of time.

[0101] Arrow **520** indicates a functionality wherein the configuring node **505** conveys to the UE **510**, information about support for one or more BWPs allocated to the UE **510**. In an example implementation, arrow **520** indicates a functionality wherein the configuring node **505** conveys to the UE **510**, information about an RF BWP allocated to the UE **510**. The baseband BWP may be already allocated to the UE **510** at this time. In one embodiment, the information provided by the configuring node **505** to the UE **510** can be one or more configuration messages formatted in a radio resource control (RRC) protocol.

[0102] Arrow **525** indicates a functionality wherein the configuring node **505** conveys to the UE **510**, information pertaining to usage of the one or more BWPs allocated to the UE **510** by the configuring node **505**. The usage information can include, for example, details about times when the one or more BWPs, particularly the RF BWP, can be used by the UE **510**. In an example implementation, the information can be activation information conveyed to the UE **510** in a downlink control information (DCI) format or in a MAC control element (MAC CE) format.

[0103] In at least some embodiments, the functions described above with reference to arrow **515**, arrow **520**, and arrow **525** can be interpreted as a provisioning handshake procedure. The provisioning handshake procedure can be performed in various alternative ways. For example, the functionality indicated by arrow **515** may be carried out in the form of the UE **510** transmitting a configuration request (in addition to, or in lieu of, the capability report) to the configuring node

505. The configuration request may be based, for example, on a desired RF BWP for a sensing operation performed over a first period of time and another configuration request may be submitted at a different time for a different sensing operation (different RF BWP) over a second period of time.

[0104] After receiving the acknowledgement of support from the configuring node **505** (indicated by arrow **520**), the UE **510** may perform a sensing operation such as, for example, by using the RF sensing system **405** described above.

[0105] Arrow **530** indicates an optional functionality wherein the UE **510** can transmit a sensing report to the configuring node **505**, such as, for example, a sensing report containing information associated with the sensing procedure performed by the UE **510**. In some cases, information associated with the sensing procedure may be made available to a user of the UE **510** and may not be transmitted to the configuring node **505**.

[0106] FIG. **6** is a flow diagram **600** showing information exchange between a UE and a configuring node to enable the UE to utilize an RF BWP in accordance with another embodiment of the disclosure. In this example embodiment, the configuring node **505** is a device that is communicatively coupled to the UE **510** via an access node **605**. The configuring node **505** in this embodiment can be, for example, the ANF **215** and/or a server (such as, for example, the SMF **221** shown in FIG. **2**). The access node **605** can be, for example, gNB **210** or ng-eNB **214**. The access node **605** operates in a flow-through mode to convey to the configuring node **505**, the capability information transmitted by the UE **510** (as indicated by arrow **620**). The configuring node **505** performs configuration operations in the manner described above with respect to the configuring node **505** shown in FIG. **6**.

[0107] Arrow **625** indicates a functionality wherein the configuring node **505** provides an indication of support for one or more BWPs allocated to the UE **510** by the configuring node **505**. In an example implementation, arrow **625** indicates a functionality wherein the configuring node **505** conveys to the access node **605**, information about an RF BWP allocated to the UE **510**. The baseband BWP may be already allocated to the UE **510** at this time.

[0108] The access node **605** receives the information about the allocated BWP(s) and performs the functionality described above with reference to arrow **525**. Subsequent operations can be similar to the operations described above with reference to FIG. **5**.

[0109] FIG. **7** shows a table **700** that includes some types of switching delays associated with some example operations performed in accordance with the disclosure. The table **700** includes a first example entry that is defined as Switching Type **1** that is associated with a switching delay “**t0**” when switching from a baseband BWP operation to an RF BWP operation. The table **700** further includes a second example entry that is defined as Switching Type **2** that is associated with a switching delay “**t1**” when switching from a RF BWP operation to a baseband BWP operation. Switching delay “**t1**” can be different than switching delay “**t0**.” The table **700** further includes a third example entry that is defined as Switching Type **3** that is associated with a switching delay “**t2**” when switching from one RF BWP operation to another RF BWP operation. Switching delay “**t2**” can be different than switching delay “**t0**” and switching delay “**t1**.” Each of the switching types may be defined and used in accordance with individual capabilities of various types of UEs.

[0110] In an example implementation, the table **700** can be an adaptation of a table that is used in existing practice (in OFDM based communication practice). In this case, the table **700** can include a Switching Type **4** that may be associated with a switching delay “**t3**” when switching from using a first baseband BWP to using a second baseband BWP.

[0111] FIG. **8** shows a table **800** that includes some example parameters that can be associated with FMCW operations in accordance with the disclosure. In an example embodiment, the table **700**, or a modified version of the table **700**, can be defined in a format based on modifying a format used in current practice for FMCW applications. Modifying the format can include, for example, modifying numerologies, modifying symbol durations, modifying integer numbers that define

sensing slots, and/or modifying slot durations. A sensing slot can be configured to include multiple FMCW signals, and each integer number may be defined as a function of a FMCW slot duration. Furthermore, an FMCW slot duration may be set to be different than an OFDM slot duration. [0112] FIG. **9** shows a flowchart **900** of a method performed by a user equipment (such as, for example, UE **205**) for executing sensing functions. Means for performing the functionality illustrated in one or more of the blocks shown in FIG. **9** may be performed by hardware and/or software components of the various components such as the components illustrated in FIG. **11**. The description below refers to various example components described herein but it must be understood that the functions can be performed by various other components that may be functionally identical or functionally similar.

[0113] At block **905**, the functionality can include transmitting, to a configuring node, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions. The configuring node can be, for example, a base station of a cellular network or a server of the cellular network. The capability information can vary from one UE to another. For example, a first type of UE may have a capability to perform high resolution sensing operations using wideband RF signals and may inform the configuring node of the capability of the first user device to use a wideband RF bandwidth that is suitable for performing the high resolution sensing operations. A second type of UE may have a limited capability to perform sensing operations and may inform the configuring node of the capability of the second type of UE to use a limited RF bandwidth that is adequate for performing these sensing operations. In an example implementation, the RF bandwidth indicated in the capability information transmitted by the UE to the configuring node can be determined based on the capabilities of a RF sensing system that can be a part of the UE. In an embodiment, the capability information may be transmitted to the configuring node based on an RRC protocol.

[0114] At block **910**, the functionality can include receiving, from the configuring node, configuration information comprising a message indicating allocation of a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) to the user equipment by the configuring node. Some additional aspects pertaining to such allocation are described above with reference to FIG. **5**.

[0115] At block **915**, the functionality can include the UE utilizing the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions. In an example implementation, the user device may utilize the RF BWP for performing sensing operations at some times and may utilize what is referred to herein as a “baseband BWP” for communication purposes at some other times. The RF BWP is typically larger than the baseband BWP. Communication operations can be based, at least in part, on orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) and sensing functions can be based, at least in part, on using frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations.

[0116] The capability information transmitted by the UE to the configuring node may also include a first switching time supported by the UE for switching between the baseband BWP and the first RF BWP and may further include a second switching time supported by the UE for switching between the first RF BWP and a second RF BWP. The second switching time may be defined, at least in part, on a first symbol duration in an FMCW format and/or a first sensing slot in the FMCW format

[0117] FIG. **10** shows a flowchart **1000** of a method performed by a configuring node to support a user equipment for performing sensing functions. Means for performing the functionality illustrated in one or more of the blocks shown in FIG. **10** may be performed by hardware and/or software components of the various components such as the components illustrated in FIG. **12**. Several portions of the description provided above with reference to the flowchart **900** are equally pertinent to the flowchart **1000** and must be understood as such.

[0118] At block **1005**, the functionality can include receiving, from the user equipment, capability information that includes a RF bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions. The configuring node can be, for example, a base station of a cellular network or a server of the

cellular network. Some aspects pertaining to the capability information are described above.

[0119] At block **1010**, the functionality can include allocating, to the UE, a first RF BWP that is based, at least in part, on the RF bandwidth supported by the UE for sensing functions. Some aspects pertaining to RF BWP are described above.

[0120] At block **1015**, the functionality can include transmitting, to the UE, information about the first RF BWP allocated to the UE.

[0121] FIG. **11** shows a block diagram of a user equipment **1105** in accordance an embodiment of the disclosure. For example, user equipment **1105** may correspond the mobile device **105** shown in FIG. **1** or the UE **205** shown in FIG. **2**. Further, as described below, the user equipment **1105** may implement an RF sensing system **1135**, which can correspond to the RF sensing system **305** described above with respect to FIG. **3** or the RF sensing system **405** described above with respect to FIG. **4**. It should be noted that FIG. **11** is meant only to provide a generalized illustration of various components, any or all of which may be utilized as appropriate. Furthermore, as previously noted, the functionality of the UE discussed in the previously described embodiments may be executed by one or more of the hardware and/or software components illustrated in FIG. **11**.

[0122] The user equipment **1105** is shown comprising hardware elements that can be electrically coupled via a bus **1140** (or may otherwise be in communication, as appropriate). The hardware elements may include a processor(s) **1110** which can include without limitation one or more general-purpose processors (e.g., an application processor), one or more special-purpose processors (such as digital signal processor (DSP) chips, graphics acceleration processors, application specific integrated circuits (ASICs), and/or the like), and/or other processing structures or means.

Processor(s) **1110** may comprise one or more processing units, which may be housed in a single integrated circuit (IC) or multiple ICs. As shown in FIG. **11**, some embodiments may have a separate DSP **1120**, depending on desired functionality. Sensing operations based on wireless communication may be provided in the processor(s) **1110** and/or wireless communication interface **1125** (discussed below). The user equipment **1105** also can include one or more input devices **1155**, which can include without limitation one or more keyboards, touch screens, touch pads, microphones, buttons, dials, switches, and/or the like; and one or more output devices **1115**, which can include without limitation one or more displays (e.g., touch screens), light emitting diodes (LEDs), speakers, and/or the like.

[0123] The user equipment **1105** may also include a wireless communication interface **1125**, which may comprise without limitation a modem, a network card, an infrared communication device, a wireless communication device, and/or a chipset (such as a Bluetooth® device, an IEEE 802.11 device, an IEEE 802.15.4 device, a Wi-Fi device, a WiMAX device, a WAN device, and/or various cellular devices, etc.), and/or the like, which may enable the user equipment **1105** to communicate and/or perform various operations as described in the embodiments above, with respect to WLAN and/or cellular technologies. The wireless communication interface **1125** may permit data and signaling to be communicated (e.g., transmitted and received) with NG-RAN nodes of a network, for example, via eNBs, gNBs, ng-eNBs, access points, NTN satellites, various base stations, TRPs, and/or other access node types, and/or other network components, computer systems, and/or any other electronic devices communicatively coupled with TRPs, as described herein. The communication can be carried out via one or more wireless communication antenna(s) **1130** that send and/or receive wireless signals **1131**. According to some embodiments, the wireless communication antenna(s) **1130** may comprise a plurality of discrete antennas, antenna arrays, or any combination thereof. The antenna(s) **1130** may be capable of transmitting and receiving wireless signals using beams (e.g., Tx beams and Rx beams). Beam formation may be performed using digital and/or analog beam formation techniques, with respective digital and/or analog circuitry. The wireless communication interface **1125** may include such circuitry.

[0124] As noted above, the mobile device **105** and/or the UE **205** may implement an RF sensing system **1135**. The RF sensing system **1135** may comprise the hardware and/or software elements

described above with respect to FIG. 3 and FIG. 4. As illustrated in FIG. 11 and noted above, some or all of the RF sensing system **1135** may be implemented within a wireless communication interface **1125**, which may utilize certain components for both communication and RF sensing. That said, embodiments are not so limited. Alternative embodiments may implement some or all of the RF sensing system **1135** separate from the wireless communication interface **1125** (e.g., in cases where RF sensing may utilize different frequencies and/or different hardware/software components than the wireless communication interface **1125**).

[0125] Depending on desired functionality, the wireless communication interface **1125** may comprise a separate receiver and transmitter, or any combination of transceivers, transmitters, and/or receivers to communicate with base stations (e.g., ng-eNBs and gNBs) and other terrestrial transceivers, such as wireless devices and access points, as well as NTN satellites. The user equipment **1105** may communicate with different data networks that may comprise various network types. For example, a WWAN may be a CDMA network, a Time Division Multiple Access (TDMA) network, a Frequency Division Multiple Access (FDMA) network, an Orthogonal Frequency Division Multiple Access (OFDMA) network, a Single-Carrier Frequency Division Multiple Access (SC-FDMA) network, a WiMAX (IEEE 802.16) network, and so on. A CDMA network may implement one or more RATs such as CDMA2000®, WCDMA, and so on. CDMA2000® includes IS-95, IS-2000 and/or IS-856 standards. A TDMA network may implement GSM, Digital Advanced Mobile Phone System (D-AMPS), or some other RAT. An OFDMA network may employ LTE, LTE Advanced, 5G NR, and so on. 5G NR, LTE, LTE Advanced, GSM, and WCDMA are described in documents from 3GPP. CDMA2000® is described in documents from a consortium named “3rd Generation Partnership Project 2” (3GPP2). 3GPP and 3GPP2 documents are publicly available. A wireless local area network (WLAN) may also be an IEEE 802.11x network, and a wireless personal area network (WPAN) may be a Bluetooth network, an IEEE 802.15x, or some other type of network. The techniques described herein may also be used for any combination of WWAN, WLAN and/or WPAN.

[0126] The user equipment **1105** can further include sensor(s) **1145**. Sensor(s) **1145** may comprise, without limitation, one or more inertial sensors and/or other sensors (e.g., accelerometer(s), gyroscope(s), camera(s), magnetometer(s), altimeter(s), microphone(s), proximity sensor(s), light sensor(s), barometer(s), and the like), some of which may be used to obtain sensing-related measurements and/or other information. Sensors **1145** may be used, for example, to detect an object and various characteristics associated with the object.

[0127] Embodiments of the user equipment **1105** may also include a Global Navigation Satellite System (GNSS) receiver **1160** capable of receiving signals **1166** from one or more GNSS satellites using an antenna **1165** (which could be the same as antenna **1130**). Positioning based on GNSS signal measurement can be utilized to complement and/or incorporate the techniques described herein. The GNSS receiver **1160** can extract a position of the user equipment **1105**, using conventional techniques, from GNSS satellites of a GNSS system, such as Global Positioning System (GPS), Galileo, GLONASS, Quasi-Zenith Satellite System (QZSS) over Japan, IRNSS over India, BeiDou Navigation Satellite System (BDS) over China, and/or the like. Moreover, the GNSS receiver **1160** can be used with various augmentation systems (e.g., a Satellite Based Augmentation System (SBAS)) that may be associated with or otherwise enabled for use with one or more global and/or regional navigation satellite systems, such as, e.g., Wide Area Augmentation System (WAAS), European Geostationary Navigation Overlay Service (EGNOS), Multi-functional Satellite Augmentation System (MSAS), and Geo Augmented Navigation system (GAGAN), and/or the like.

[0128] It can be noted that, although GNSS receiver **1160** is illustrated in FIG. 11 as a distinct component, embodiments are not so limited. As used herein, the term “GNSS receiver” may comprise hardware and/or software components configured to obtain GNSS measurements (measurements from GNSS satellites). In some embodiments, therefore, the GNSS receiver may

comprise a measurement engine executed (as software) by one or more processors, such as processor(s) **1110**, DSP **1120**, and/or a processor within the wireless communication interface **1125** (e.g., in a modem). A GNSS receiver may optionally also include a positioning engine, which can use GNSS measurements from the measurement engine to determine a position of the GNSS receiver using an Extended Kalman Filter (EKF), Weighted Least Squares (WLS), particle filter, or the like. The positioning engine may also be executed by one or more processors, such as processor(s) **1110** or DSP **1120**.

[0129] The user equipment **1105** may further include and/or be in communication with a memory **1150**. The memory **1150** can include, without limitation, local and/or network accessible storage, a disk drive, a drive array, an optical storage device, a solid-state storage device, such as a random-access memory (RAM), and/or a read-only memory (ROM), which can be programmable, flash-updateable, and/or the like. Such storage devices may be configured to implement any appropriate data stores, including without limitation, various file systems, database structures, and/or the like.

[0130] The memory **1150** of the user equipment **1105** also can comprise software elements (not shown in FIG. **11**), including an operating system, device drivers, executable libraries, and/or other code, such as one or more application programs, which may comprise computer programs provided by various embodiments, and/or may be designed to implement methods, and/or configure systems, provided by other embodiments, as described herein. Merely by way of example, one or more procedures described with respect to the method(s) discussed above may be implemented as code and/or instructions in memory **1150** that are executable by the user equipment **1105** (and/or processor(s) **1110** or DSP **1120** within user equipment **1105**). In some embodiments, then, such code and/or instructions can be used to configure and/or adapt a general-purpose computer (or other device) to perform one or more operations in accordance with the described methods.

[0131] FIG. **12** is a block diagram of a network node **1205** in accordance an embodiment of the disclosure. According to some embodiments, the network node **1205** may function as a configuring node as described herein. As such, the network node **1205** may be capable of performing some or all of the functionality described in the method shown in FIG. **10**. It should be noted that FIG. **12** is meant only to provide a generalized illustration of various components, any or all of which may be utilized as appropriate. In some embodiments, the network node **1205** may correspond to the gNB **210**, the ng-eNB **214**, ANF **215**, or the SMF **221** shown in FIG. **2** and/or (more generally) a TRP. In some cases, the network node **1205** may comprise multiple TRPs—e.g. with each TRP associated with a different antenna or a different antenna array of the network node **1205**. As used herein, the transmission functionality of a TRP may be performed with a transmission point (TP) and/or the reception functionality of a TRP may be performed by a reception point (RP), which may be physically separate or distinct from a TP. That said, a TRP may comprise both a TP and an RP.

[0132] The functionality performed by the network node **1205** in earlier-generation networks (e.g., 3G and 4G) may be separated into different functional components (e.g., radio units (RUs), distributed units (DUs), and central units (CUs)) and layers (e.g., L1/L2/L3) in view Open Radio Access Networks (O-RAN) and/or Virtualized Radio Access Network (V-RAN or vRAN) in 5G or later networks, which may be executed on different devices at different locations connected, for example, via fronthaul, midhaul, and backhaul connections. As referred to herein, a “base station” (or ng-eNB, gNB, etc.) may include any or all of these functional components. The functionality of these functional components may be performed by one or more of the hardware and/or software components illustrated in FIG. **12**.

[0133] The network node **1205** is shown comprising hardware elements that can be electrically coupled via a bus **1225** (or may otherwise be in communication, as appropriate). The hardware elements may include a processor(s) **1210** which can include without limitation one or more general-purpose processors, one or more special-purpose processors (such as digital signal processor (DSP) chips, graphics acceleration processors, application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs), and/or the like), and/or other processing structure or means. As shown in FIG. **12**, some

embodiments may have a separate DSP **1215**, depending on desired functionality. The network node **1205** also can include one or more input devices, which can include without limitation a keyboard, display, mouse, microphone, button(s), dial(s), switch(es), and/or the like; and one or more output devices, which can include without limitation a display, light emitting diode (LED), speakers, and/or the like.

[0134] The network node **1205** might also include a wireless communication interface **1220**, which may comprise without limitation a modem, a network card, an infrared communication device, a wireless communication device, and/or a chipset (such as a Bluetooth® device, an IEEE 802.11 device, an IEEE 802.15.4 device, a Wi-Fi device, a WiMAX device, cellular communication facilities, etc.), and/or the like, which may enable the network node **1205** to communicate as described herein. The wireless communication interface **1220** may permit data and signaling to be communicated (e.g., transmitted and received) to UEs, other base stations/TRPs (e.g., eNBs, gNBs, and ng-eNBs), and/or other network components, computer systems, and/or other electronic devices described herein. The communication can be carried out via one or more wireless communication antenna(s) **1221** that send and/or receive wireless signals **1222**. According to some embodiments, one or more wireless communication antenna(s) **1221** may comprise one or more antenna arrays, which may be capable of beamforming.

[0135] The network node **1205** may also include a network interface **1235**, which can include support of wireline communication technologies. The network interface **1235** may include a modem, network card, chipset, and/or the like. The network interface **1235** may include one or more input and/or output communication interfaces to permit data to be exchanged with a network, communication network servers, computer systems, and/or any other electronic devices described herein.

[0136] In many embodiments, the network node **1205** may further comprise a memory **1230**. The memory **1230** can include, without limitation, local and/or network accessible storage, a disk drive, a drive array, an optical storage device, a solid-state storage device, such as a random-access memory (RAM), and/or a read-only memory (ROM), which can be programmable, flash-updateable, and/or the like. Such storage devices may be configured to implement any appropriate data stores, including without limitation, various file systems, database structures, and/or the like.

[0137] The memory **1230** of the network node **1205** also may comprise software elements (not shown in FIG. **12**), including an operating system, device drivers, executable libraries, and/or other code, such as one or more application programs, which may comprise computer programs provided by various embodiments, and/or may be designed to implement methods, and/or configure systems, provided by other embodiments, as described herein. Merely by way of example, one or more procedures described with respect to the method(s) discussed above may be implemented as code and/or instructions in memory **1230** that are executable by the network node **1205** (and/or processor(s) **1210** or DSP **1215** within network node **1205**). In some embodiments, then, such code and/or instructions can be used to configure and/or adapt a general-purpose computer (or other device) to perform one or more operations in accordance with the described methods.

[0138] FIG. **13** is a block diagram of an embodiment of a computer system **1300**, which may be used, in whole or in part, to provide the functions of one or more components and/or devices as described in the embodiments herein. The computer system **1300**, for example, may be utilized within and/or executed by a server (e.g., SMF **221**), which may perform the functions of a configuring node (e.g., configuring node **505** of FIG. **6** and FIG. **7**) as described herein. It should be noted that FIG. **13** is meant only to provide a generalized illustration of various components, any or all of which may be utilized as appropriate. FIG. **13**, therefore, broadly illustrates how individual system elements may be implemented in a relatively separated or relatively more integrated manner. In addition, it can be noted that components illustrated by FIG. **13** can be localized to a single device and/or distributed among various networked devices, which may be disposed at different geographical locations.

[0139] The computer system **1300** is shown comprising hardware elements that can be electrically coupled via a bus **1305** (or may otherwise be in communication, as appropriate). The hardware elements may include processor(s) **1310**, which may comprise without limitation one or more general-purpose processors, one or more special-purpose processors (such as digital signal processing chips, graphics acceleration processors, and/or the like), and/or other processing structure, which can be configured to perform one or more of the methods described herein. The computer system **1300** also may comprise one or more input devices **1320**, which may comprise without limitation a mouse, a keyboard, a camera, a microphone, and/or the like; and one or more output devices **1325**, which may comprise without limitation a display device, a printer, and/or the like.

[0140] The computer system **1300** may further include (and/or be in communication with) one or more non-transitory storage devices **1315**, which can comprise, without limitation, local and/or network accessible storage, and/or may comprise, without limitation, a disk drive, a drive array, an optical storage device, a solid-state storage device, such as a random-access memory (RAM) and/or read-only memory (ROM), which can be programmable, flash-updateable, and/or the like. Such storage devices may be configured to implement any appropriate data stores, including without limitation, various file systems, database structures, and/or the like. Such data stores may include database(s) and/or other data structures used store and administer messages and/or other information to be sent to one or more devices via hubs, as described herein.

[0141] The computer system **1300** may also include a communications subsystem **1330**, which may comprise wireless communication technologies managed and controlled by a wireless communication interface **1335**, as well as wired technologies (such as Ethernet, coaxial communications, universal serial bus (USB), and the like). The wireless communication interface **1335** may comprise one or more wireless transceivers that may send and receive wireless signals **1337** (e.g., signals according to 5G NR or LTE) via wireless antenna(s) **1336**. Thus the communications subsystem **1330** may comprise a modem, a network card (wireless or wired), an infrared communication device, a wireless communication device, and/or a chipset, and/or the like, which may enable the computer system **1300** to communicate on any or all of the communication networks described herein to any device on the respective network, including UE, base stations and/or other transmission reception points (TRPs), satellites, and/or any other electronic devices described herein. Hence, the communications subsystem **1330** may be used to receive and send data as described in the embodiments herein.

[0142] In many embodiments, the computer system **1300** will further comprise a working memory **1340**, which may comprise a RAM or ROM device, as described above. Software elements, shown as being located within the working memory **1340**, may comprise an operating system **1345**, device drivers, executable libraries, and/or other code, such as one or more applications **1350**, which may comprise computer programs provided by various embodiments, and/or may be designed to implement methods, and/or configure systems, provided by other embodiments, as described herein. Merely by way of example, one or more procedures described with respect to the method(s) discussed above might be implemented as code and/or instructions executable by a computer (and/or a processor within a computer); in an aspect, then, such code and/or instructions can be used to configure and/or adapt a general purpose computer (or other device) to perform one or more operations in accordance with the described methods.

[0143] A set of these instructions and/or code might be stored on a non-transitory computer-readable storage medium, such as the storage device(s) **1315** described above. In some cases, the storage medium might be incorporated within a computer system, such as computer system **1300**. In other embodiments, the storage medium might be separate from a computer system (e.g., a removable medium, such as an optical disc), and/or provided in an installation package, such that the storage medium can be used to program, configure, and/or adapt a general-purpose computer with the instructions/code stored thereon. These instructions might take the form of executable

code, which is executable by the computer system 1300 and/or might take the form of source and/or installable code, which, upon compilation and/or installation on the computer system 1300 (e.g., using any of a variety of generally available compilers, installation programs, compression/decompression utilities, etc.), then takes the form of executable code.

[0144] It will be apparent to those skilled in the art that substantial variations may be made in accordance with specific requirements. For example, customized hardware might also be used and/or particular elements might be implemented in hardware, software (including portable software, such as applets, etc.), or both. Further, connection to other computing devices such as network input/output devices may be employed.

[0145] With reference to the appended figures, components that can include memory can include non-transitory machine-readable media. The term “machine-readable medium” and “computer-readable medium” as used herein, refer to any storage medium that participates in providing data that causes a machine to operate in a specific fashion. In embodiments provided hereinabove, various machine-readable media might be involved in providing instructions/code to processors and/or other device(s) for execution. Additionally or alternatively, the machine-readable media might be used to store and/or carry such instructions/code. In many implementations, a computer-readable medium is a physical and/or tangible storage medium. Such a medium may take many forms, including but not limited to, non-volatile media and volatile media. Common forms of computer-readable media include, for example, magnetic and/or optical media, any other physical medium with patterns of holes, a RAM, a programmable ROM (PROM), erasable PROM (EPROM), a FLASH-EPROM, any other memory chip or cartridge, or any other medium from which a computer can read instructions and/or code.

[0146] The methods, systems, and devices discussed herein are examples. Various embodiments may omit, substitute, or add various procedures or components as appropriate. For instance, features described with respect to certain embodiments may be combined in various other embodiments. Different aspects and elements of the embodiments may be combined in a similar manner. The various components of the figures provided herein can be embodied in hardware and/or software. Also, technology evolves and, thus many of the elements are examples that do not limit the scope of the disclosure to those specific examples.

[0147] It has proven convenient at times, principally for reasons of common usage, to refer to such signals as bits, information, values, elements, symbols, characters, variables, terms, numbers, numerals, or the like. It should be understood, however, that all of these or similar terms are to be associated with appropriate physical quantities and are merely convenient labels. Unless specifically stated otherwise, as is apparent from the discussion above, it is appreciated that throughout this Specification discussion utilizing terms such as “processing,” “computing,” “calculating,” “determining,” “ascertaining,” “identifying,” “associating,” “measuring,” “performing,” or the like refer to actions or processes of a specific apparatus, such as a special purpose computer or a similar special purpose electronic computing device. In the context of this Specification, therefore, a special purpose computer or a similar special purpose electronic computing device is capable of manipulating or transforming signals, typically represented as physical electronic, electrical, or magnetic quantities within memories, registers, or other information storage devices, transmission devices, or display devices of the special purpose computer or similar special purpose electronic computing device.

[0148] Terms, “and” and “or” as used herein, may include a variety of meanings that also is expected to depend, at least in part, upon the context in which such terms are used. Typically, “or” if used to associate a list, such as A, B, or C, is intended to mean A, B, and C, here used in the inclusive sense, as well as A, B, or C, here used in the exclusive sense. In addition, the term “one or more” as used herein may be used to describe any feature, structure, or characteristic in the singular or may be used to describe some combination of features, structures, or characteristics. However, it should be noted that this is merely an illustrative example and claimed subject matter is not limited

to this example. Furthermore, the term “at least one of” if used to associate a list, such as A, B, or C, can be interpreted to mean any combination of A, B, and/or C, such as A, AB, AA, AAB, AABBBCC, etc.

[0149] Having described several embodiments, various modifications, alternative constructions, and equivalents may be used without departing from the scope of the disclosure. For example, the above elements may merely be a component of a larger system, wherein other rules may take precedence over or otherwise modify the application of the various embodiments. Also, a number of steps may be undertaken before, during, or after the above elements are considered. Accordingly, the above description does not limit the scope of the disclosure.

[0150] In view of this description embodiments may include different combinations of features. Implementation examples are described in the following numbered clauses:

[0151] Clause 1: A method performed by a user equipment to configure the user equipment for sensing functions, the method comprising transmitting, to a configuring node, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; receiving, from the configuring node, configuration information comprising a message indicating allocation of a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) to the user equipment by the configuring node; and utilizing the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions.

[0152] Clause 2: The method of clause 1, wherein the first RF BWP is larger than a baseband BWP allocated to the user equipment.

[0153] Clause 3: The method of clause 2, wherein the baseband BWP is used by the user equipment for communication operations that are based, at least in part, on orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) and wherein the sensing functions are based, at least in part, on using frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations.

[0154] Clause 4: The method of any of clauses 1-3, wherein transmitting the capability information to the configuring node is based on a radio resource control protocol.

[0155] Clause 5: The method of any of clauses 1-4, wherein the capability information further comprises a first switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the baseband BWP and the first RF BWP.

[0156] Clause 6: The method of clause 5, wherein the capability information further comprises a second switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the first RF BWP and a second RF BWP.

[0157] Clause 7: The method of clause 6, wherein the second switching time is defined, at least in part, on at least one of a first symbol duration in an FMCW format or a first sensing slot in the FMCW format.

[0158] Clause 8: The method of clause 2, further comprising utilizing the baseband BWP for performing communication operations concurrently with utilizing the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions.

[0159] Clause 9: A method performed by a configuring node to support a user equipment for performing sensing functions, the method comprising receiving, from the user equipment, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; allocating, to the user equipment, a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) that is based, at least in part, on the RF bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; and transmitting, to the user equipment, information about the first RF BWP allocated to the user equipment.

[0160] Clause 10: The method of clause 9, wherein the first RF BWP is larger than a baseband BWP allocated to the user equipment.

[0161] Clause 11: The method of clause 10, wherein the baseband BWP is used for communication operations that are based, at least in part, on orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) and wherein the sensing functions are based, at least in part, on using frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations.

[0162] Clause 12: The method of any of clauses 9-11, wherein receiving the capability information from the user equipment is based on a radio resource control protocol.

[0163] Clause 13: The method of any of clauses 10-12, wherein the capability information further comprises a first switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the baseband BWP and the first RF BWP.

[0164] Clause 14: The method of clause 13, wherein the capability information further comprises a second switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the first RF BWP and a second RF BWP.

[0165] Clause 15: The method of clause 14, wherein the second switching time is defined, at least in part, on at least one of a first symbol duration in an FMCW format or a first sensing slot in the FMCW format.

[0166] Clause 16: The method of claim 9, wherein the information transmitted to the user equipment about the first RF BWP comprises a message formatted in a radio resource control protocol.

[0167] Clause 17: A user equipment that performs sensing functions, comprising at least one memory and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the at least one memory. The one or more processors are configured to transmit, to a configuring node, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; receive, from the configuring node, configuration information comprising a message indicating allocation of a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) to the user equipment by the configuring node; and utilize the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions.

[0168] Clause 18: The user equipment of clause 17, wherein the configuring node is one of a base station of a cellular network or a server of the cellular network and wherein the first RF BWP is larger than a baseband BWP allocated to the user equipment.

[0169] Clause 19: The user equipment of clause 18, wherein the baseband BWP is used for communication operations that are based, at least in part, on orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) and wherein the sensing functions are based, at least in part, on using frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations.

[0170] Clause 20: The user equipment of any of clauses 17-19, wherein the capability information transmitted to the configuring node is based on a radio resource control protocol.

[0171] Clause 21: The user equipment of any of clauses 17-20, wherein the capability information further comprises a first switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the baseband BWP and the first RF BWP.

[0172] Clause 22: The user equipment of clause 21, wherein the capability information further comprises a second switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the first RF BWP and a second RF BWP.

[0173] Clause 23: The user equipment of clause 22, wherein the second switching time is defined, at least in part, on at least one of a first symbol duration in an FMCW format or a first sensing slot in the FMCW format.

[0174] Clause 24: A configuring node that supports a user equipment for performing sensing functions, comprising at least one memory and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the at least one memory. The one or more processors are configured to receive, from the user equipment, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; allocate, to the user equipment, a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) that is based, at least in part, on the RF bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; and transmit, to the user equipment, information about the first RF BWP allocated to the user equipment.

[0175] Clause 25: The configuring node of clause 24, wherein the configuring node is one of a base station of a cellular network or a server of the cellular network, and wherein the first RF BWP is larger than a baseband BWP allocated to the user equipment.

[0176] Clause 26: The configuring node of clause 24 or 25, wherein the baseband BWP is used for communication operations that are based, at least in part, on orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) and wherein the sensing functions are based, at least in part, on using frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations.

[0177] Clause 27: The configuring node of clauses 24-26, wherein the capability information received from the user equipment is based on a radio resource control protocol.

[0178] Clause 28: The configuring node of clauses 24-27, wherein the capability information further comprises a first switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the baseband BWP and the first RF BWP.

[0179] Clause 29: The configuring node of clause 28, wherein the capability information further comprises a second switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the first RF BWP and a second RF BWP.

[0180] Clause 30: The configuring node of clause 29, wherein the second switching time is defined, at least in part, on at least one of a first symbol duration in an FMCW format or a first sensing slot in the FMCW format.

[0181] Clause 31: An apparatus having means for performing the method of any of clauses 1-8.

[0182] Clause 32: An apparatus having means for performing the method of any of clauses 9-16.

[0183] Clause 33: A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing instructions, the instructions comprising code for performing the method of any of clauses 1-8.

[0184] Clause 34: A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing instructions, the instructions comprising code for performing the method of any of clauses 9-16.

Claims

1. A method performed by a user equipment to configure the user equipment for sensing functions, the method comprising: transmitting, to a configuring node, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; receiving, from the configuring node, configuration information comprising a message indicating allocation of a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) to the user equipment by the configuring node; and utilizing the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the first RF BWP is larger than a baseband BWP allocated to the user equipment for communication operations.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the baseband BWP is used by the user equipment for communication operations that are based, at least in part, on orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) and wherein the sensing functions are based, at least in part, on using frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations.
4. The method of claim 3, wherein transmitting the capability information to the configuring node is based on a radio resource control protocol.
5. The method of claim 2, wherein the capability information further comprises a first switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the baseband BWP and the first RF BWP.
6. The method of claim 5, wherein the capability information further comprises a second switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the first RF BWP and a second RF BWP.
7. The method of claim 6, wherein the second switching time is defined, at least in part, on at least one of a first symbol duration in an FMCW format or a first sensing slot in the FMCW format.
8. The method of claim 2, further comprising: utilizing the baseband BWP for performing communication operations concurrently with utilizing the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions.
9. A method performed by a configuring node to support a user equipment for performing sensing

functions, the method comprising: receiving, from the user equipment, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; allocating, to the user equipment, a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) that is based, at least in part, on the RF bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; and transmitting, to the user equipment, information about the first RF BWP allocated to the user equipment.

10. The method of claim 9, wherein the first RF BWP is larger than a baseband BWP allocated to the user equipment for communication purposes.

11. The method of claim 10, wherein the baseband BWP is used for communication operations that are based, at least in part, on orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) and wherein the sensing functions are based, at least in part, on using frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein receiving the capability information from the user equipment is based on a radio resource control protocol.

13. The method of claim 10, wherein the capability information further comprises a first switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the baseband BWP and the first RF BWP.

14. The method of claim 13, wherein the capability information further comprises a second switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the first RF BWP and a second RF BWP.

15. The method of claim 14, wherein the second switching time is defined, at least in part, on at least one of a first symbol duration in an FMCW format or a first sensing slot in the FMCW format.

16. The method of claim 9, wherein the information transmitted to the user equipment about the first RF BWP comprises a message formatted in a radio resource control protocol.

17. A user equipment that performs sensing functions, comprising: at least one memory; and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the at least one memory, the one or more processors configured to: transmit, to a configuring node, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; receive, from the configuring node, configuration information comprising a message indicating allocation of a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) to the user equipment by the configuring node; and utilize the first RF BWP for performing sensing functions.

18. The user equipment of claim 17, wherein the configuring node is one of a base station of a cellular network or a server of the cellular network and wherein the first RF BWP is larger than a baseband BWP allocated to the user equipment.

19. The user equipment of claim 18, wherein the baseband BWP is used by the user equipment for communication operations that are based, at least in part, on orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) and wherein the sensing functions are based, at least in part, on using frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations.

20. The user equipment of claim 19, wherein the capability information transmitted to the configuring node is based on a radio resource control protocol.

21. The user equipment of claim 18, wherein the capability information further comprises a first switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the baseband BWP and the first RF BWP.

22. The user equipment of claim 21, wherein the capability information further comprises a second switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the first RF BWP and a second RF BWP.

23. The user equipment of claim 22, wherein the second switching time is defined, at least in part, on at least one of a first symbol duration in an FMCW format or a first sensing slot in the FMCW format.

24. A configuring node that supports a user equipment for performing sensing functions,

comprising: at least one memory; and one or more processors communicatively coupled with the at least one memory, the one or more processors configured to: receive, from the user equipment, capability information comprising a radio frequency (RF) bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; allocate, to the user equipment, a first RF bandwidth part (BWP) that is based, at least in part, on the RF bandwidth supported by the user equipment for sensing functions; and transmit, to the user equipment, information about the first RF BWP allocated to the user equipment.

25. The configuring node of claim 24, wherein the configuring node is one of a base station of a cellular network or a server of the cellular network, and wherein the first RF BWP is larger than a baseband BWP allocated to the user equipment.

26. The configuring node of claim 25, wherein the baseband BWP is used by the user equipment for communication operations that are based, at least in part, on orthogonal frequency division multiplexing (OFDM) and wherein the sensing functions are based, at least in part, on using frequency modulated continuous wave (FMCW) operations.

27. The configuring node of claim 26, wherein the capability information received from the user equipment is based on a radio resource control protocol.

28. The configuring node of claim 25, wherein the capability information further comprises a first switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the baseband BWP and the first RF BWP.

29. The configuring node of claim 28, wherein the capability information further comprises a second switching time supported by the user equipment for switching between the first RF BWP and a second RF BWP.

30. The configuring node of claim 29, wherein the second switching time is defined, at least in part, on at least one of a first symbol duration in an FMCW format or a first sensing slot in the FMCW format.
